



Santa Claus

Santa Claus (also known as **Saint Nicholas**, **Saint Nick**, **Father Christmas**, **Kris Kringle** or **Santa**) is a legendary figure^[1] originating in Western Christian culture who is said to bring gifts during the late evening and overnight hours on Christmas Eve. Christmas elves are said to make the gifts in Santa's workshop, while flying reindeer pull his sleigh through the air.^{[2][3]}

The popular conception of Santa Claus originates from folklore traditions surrounding the 4th-century Christian bishop Saint Nicholas, the patron saint of children. Saint Nicholas became renowned for his reported generosity and secret gift-giving. The image of Santa Claus shares similarities with the English figure of Father Christmas, and they are both now popularly regarded as the same person.^[4]

Santa is generally depicted as a portly, jolly, white-bearded man, often with glasses, wearing a red coat with white fur collar and cuffs, white-fur-cuffed red trousers, a red hat trimmed with white fur, a black leather belt and boots, carrying a bag full of gifts for children. He is popularly associated with a deep, hearty laugh, frequently rendered in Christmas literature as "ho, ho, ho!"

This image originated in the United States during the 19th century, after Dutch settlers brought the legend of Sinterklaas ("Saint Nicholas") to 17th-century New Amsterdam (present-day New York City). The 1823 American poem "A Visit from St. Nicholas", written by an anonymous author, recounts Saint Nicholas arriving at the author's home on Christmas Eve in a sleigh pulled by flying reindeer. The poem laid the foundation for modern depictions of Santa Claus, strengthening the association between Santa Claus and Christmas. Over time, this connection has been maintained and reinforced through song, radio, television, children's books, family Christmas traditions, films, and advertising.^{[5][6]}

Santa Claus



1863 illustration by Thomas Nast

Associates	<u>Elves</u> · <u>Reindeer</u>
Attire	<u>Santa suit</u>
Aliases	<u>Saint Nicholas</u> , <u>Saint Nick</u> , <u>Kris Kringle</u> , <u>Santa</u> , <u>Father Christmas</u>
Gender	Male
Occupation	<u>Delivering gifts to children on Christmas</u>
Spouse	<u>Mrs. Claus</u>
Home	<u>North Pole</u> (<u>Santa's workshop</u>) · <u>Lapland</u> (<u>Santa Claus Village</u>)

Predecessor figures

Saint Nicholas

Saint Nicholas was a 4th-century Greek Christian bishop of Myra (now Demre) in the region of Lycia in the Roman Empire, today in Turkey. Nicholas was known for his generous gifts to the poor, in particular presenting the three impoverished daughters of a pious Christian with dowries so that they would not have to become prostitutes.^[7] He was very religious from an early age and devoted his life entirely to Christianity. In continental Europe (more precisely the Netherlands, Belgium, Austria, the Czech Republic and Germany), he is usually portrayed as a bearded bishop in canonical robes.

In 1087, while the Greek Christian inhabitants of Myra were subjugated by the newly arrived Muslim Seljuq dynasty, and soon after their Greek Orthodox church had been declared to be in schism by the Catholic Church (AD 1054), a group of merchants from the Italian city of Bari removed the major bones of Nicholas's skeleton from his sarcophagus in the Greek church in Myra. Over the objection of the monks of Myra the sailors took the bones of Saint Nicholas to Bari, where they are now enshrined in the Basilica di San Nicola. Sailors from Bari collected just half of Nicholas's skeleton, leaving all the minor fragments in the church sarcophagus. These were later taken by Venetian sailors during the First Crusade and placed in Venice, where a church dedicated to Saint Nicholas, the patron of sailors, was built on the San Nicolò al Lido. Saint Nicholas's vandalised sarcophagus can still be seen in the St. Nicholas Church in Myra. This tradition was confirmed in two important scientific investigations of the relics in Bari and Venice, which revealed that the relics in the two Italian cities belong to the same skeleton. Saint Nicholas was later claimed as a patron saint of many diverse groups, from archers, sailors, and children to pawnbrokers.^{[7][8]} He is also the patron saint of both Amsterdam and Moscow.^[9]

During the Middle Ages, often on the evening before his name day of 6 December, children were bestowed gifts in his honour. This date was earlier than the original day of gifts for the children, which moved in the course of the Reformation and its opposition to the veneration of saints in many countries on 24 and 25 December. The custom of gifting to children at Christmas was propagated by Martin Luther as an alternative to the previous very popular gift custom attention on Saint Nicholas, to focus the interest of the children to Christ instead of the veneration of saints. Luther first suggested the Christkind as the bringer of gifts. But Nicholas remained popular as gifts bearer for the people.^{[10][11]}



A 13th-century depiction of Saint Nicholas from Saint Catherine's Monastery, Sinai

Father Christmas

Father Christmas dates to 16th-century England during the reign of Henry VIII, when he was pictured as a large man in green or scarlet robes lined with fur.^[12] He typified the spirit of good cheer at Christmas, bringing peace, joy, good food and wine and revelry.^[12] As England no longer kept the feast day of Saint Nicholas on 6 December, the Father Christmas celebration was moved to 25 December to coincide with Christmas Day.^[12] The Victorian revival of Christmas included Father Christmas as the emblem of good cheer.^[13] His physical appearance was variable,^[14] with one image being John Leech's illustration of the "Ghost of Christmas Present" in Charles Dickens's novella *A Christmas Carol* (1843), as a great genial man in a green coat lined with fur who takes Ebenezer Scrooge through the bustling streets of London on the current Christmas morning, sprinkling the essence of Christmas onto the happy populace.^{[12][13]}

Dutch, Belgian and Swiss folklore

In the Netherlands and Belgium, the character of Santa Claus competes with that of Sinterklaas, based on Saint Nicolas. Santa Claus is known as *de Kerstman* in Dutch ("the Christmas man") and *Père Noël* ("Father Christmas") in French. For children in the Netherlands, Sinterklaas remains the predominant gift-giver in December; 36% of the Dutch only give presents on Sinterklaas evening or the day itself, 6 December,^[15] while Christmas, 25 December, is used by another 21% to give presents. Some 26% of the Dutch population gives presents on both days.^[16] In Belgium, presents are offered exclusively to children on 6 December, and on Christmas Day all ages may receive presents. Saint Nicolas/Sinterklaas' assistants are called "Pieten" (in Dutch) or "Père Fouettard" (in French), and they are not elves.^[17]

In Switzerland, *Père Fouettard* accompanies *Père Noël* in the French speaking region, while the sinister *Schmutzli* accompanies *Samichlaus* in the Swiss German region. *Schmutzli* carries a twig broom to spank the naughty children.^[18]

Germanic paganism, Odin, and Christianisation

Prior to their Christianisation, the Germanic peoples (including the English) celebrated a midwinter event called Yule (Old English *geola* or *giuli*).^[19] With the Christianisation of Germanic Europe, numerous traditions were absorbed from Yuletide celebrations into modern Christmas,^[20] such as the Wild Hunt, frequently attested as being led by the god Odin (Wodan), bearing (among many names) the names *Jólnir*, meaning "Yule man", and *Langbarðr*, meaning "long-beard", in Old Norse.^[21]



The Ghost of Christmas Present as illustrated by John Leech for Charles Dickens's *A Christmas Carol* (1843)



Sinterklaas, Netherlands (2009) on his horse named *Amerigo*

Odin's role during the Yuletide period has been theorised as having influenced concepts of Saint Nicholas and Santa Claus in a variety of facets, including his long white beard and his grey horse for nightly rides (compare Odin's horse Sleipnir) or his reindeer in North American tradition.^[22] The folklorist Margaret Baker maintains that "the appearance of Santa Claus or Father Christmas, whose day is the 25th of December, owes much to Odin, the old blue-hooded, cloaked, white-bearded Giftbringer of the north, who rode the midwinter sky on his eight-footed steed Sleipnir, visiting his people with gifts. Odin, transformed into Father Christmas, then Santa Claus, prospered with St Nicholas and the Christchild, became a leading player on the Christmas stage."^[23]

In northern Europe, the Yule goat was an earlier bearer of gifts, which has to some degree become conflated with Santa Claus, for instance in the Finnish Joulupukki tradition.^[24]

History

Origins

Early representations of the gift-giver from Church history and folklore, especially Saint Nicholas, merged with the English character Father Christmas to create the mythical character known to the rest of the English-speaking world as "Santa Claus" (a phonetic derivation of "Sinterklaas" in Dutch).

In the English and later British colonies of North America, and later in the United States, British and Dutch versions of the gift-giver merged further. For example, in Washington Irving's *History of New York* (1809), *Sinterklaas* was Anglicised into "Santa Claus" (a name first used in the U.S. press in 1773)^[25] but lost his bishop's apparel, and was at first pictured as a thick-bellied Dutch sailor with a pipe in a green winter coat. Irving's book was a parody of the Dutch culture of New York, and much of this portrait is his joking invention.^[26] Irving's interpretation of Santa Claus was part of a broader movement to tone down the increasingly wild Christmas celebrations of the era, which included aggressive home invasions under the guise of wassailing, substantial premarital sex (leading to shotgun weddings in areas where the Puritans, waning in power and firmly opposed to Christmas, still held some influence) and public displays of sexual deviancy; the celebrations of the era were derided by both upper-class merchants and Christian purists.^[26]



1850 illustration of *Saint Nicholas* and his servant *Père Fouettard*/*Zwarte Piet*



An 1886 depiction of the long-bearded Norse god *Odin* by *Georg von Rosen*

19th century

In 1821 the book *A New-year's present, to the little ones from five to twelve* was published in New York. It contained "Old Santeclaus with Much Delight", an anonymous poem describing Santeclaus on a reindeer sleigh, bringing rewards to children.^[27] Some modern ideas of Santa Claus seemingly became canon after the anonymous publication of the poem *A Visit From St. Nicholas* (better known today as *The Night Before Christmas*) in the *Troy, New York Sentinel* on 23 December 1823; Clement Clarke Moore later claimed authorship, though others have argued that the author was Henry Livingston Jr., although he had never claimed authorship of the piece and died nine years before Moore revealed himself as the author.^{[7][28]} Saint Nicholas is described as being "chubby and plump, a right jolly old elf" with "a little round belly", that "shook when he laughed like a bowlful of jelly", in spite of which the "miniature sleigh" and "tiny reindeer" still indicate that he is physically diminutive. The reindeer were also named: Dasher, Dancer, Prancer, Vixen, Comet, Cupid, Dunder and Blixem (Dunder and Blixem came from the old Dutch words for thunder and lightning, which were later changed to the more German sounding Donner and Blitzen).^[29]

By 1845 "Kris Kringle" (from "Christkindl(e)", German for "Christ-child") was a common variant of Santa in parts of the United States.^[30] A magazine article from 1853, describing American Christmas customs to British readers, refers to children hanging up their stockings on Christmas Eve for "a fabulous personage" whose name varies: in Pennsylvania he is usually called "Krishkinkle", but in New York he is "St. Nicholas" or "Santa Claus". The author^[31] quotes Moore's poem in its entirety, saying that its descriptions apply to Krishkinkle too.^[32]

As the years passed, Santa Claus evolved into a large, heavyset person. One of the first artists to define the modern image of the modern image of Santa Claus was Thomas Nast, a German-born American cartoonist of the 19th century who immortalised Santa Claus with an illustration for the 3 January 1863 issue of *Harper's Weekly* in which Santa was dressed in an American flag, and had a puppet with the name "Jeff" written on it, reflecting its American Civil War context. Nast was inspired by the Belsnickel, part of the folklore in southwestern Germany, where he was born.^[33] In this drawing, Santa is also in a sleigh pulled by reindeer.

The story that Santa Claus lives at the North Pole may also have been a Nast creation. His Christmas image in the *Harper's* issue dated 29 December 1866 was a collage of engravings titled *Santa Claus and His Works*, which included the caption "Santa Claussville, N.P."^[34] A colour collection of Nast's pictures, published in 1869, had a poem also titled "Santa Claus and His Works" by George P.



Illustration to verse 1 of "Old Santeclaus with Much Delight"



Francis Pharcellus Church, author of the famous 1897 *The Sun* editorial which, responding to a letter from eight-year old Virginia O'Hanlon, contains the line "Yes, Virginia, there is a Santa Claus"

Webster, who wrote that Santa Claus's home was "near the North Pole, in the ice and snow".^[35] The tale had become well known by the 1870s. A boy from Colorado writing to the children's magazine *The Nursery* in late 1874 said, "If we did not live so very far from the North Pole, I should ask Santa Claus to bring me a donkey."^[36]

The idea of a wife for Santa Claus may have been the creation of American authors, beginning in the mid-19th century. In 1889, the poet Katharine Lee Bates popularised Mrs Claus in the poem "Goody Santa Claus on a Sleigh Ride". "Is There a Santa Claus?" is the title of an iconic editorial by Francis Pharcellus Church in the 21 September 1897 edition of *The New York Sun* that became the most reprinted in the US and included the famous reply, "Yes, Virginia, there is a Santa Claus".^{[37][38]}

20th century

L. Frank Baum's *The Life and Adventures of Santa Claus*, a children's book, was published in 1902. Much of Santa Claus's mythos was not firmly established at the time, leaving Baum to give his "Neclaus" (Necile's Little One) a variety of immortal support, a home in the Laughing Valley of Hohaho, and *ten* reindeer—who could not fly, but leapt in enormous, flight-like bounds. Claus's immortality was earned, much like his title ("Santa"), decided by a vote of those naturally immortal. This work also established Santa's motives: a happy childhood among immortals. When Ak, Master Woodsman of the World, exposes him to the misery and poverty of children in the outside world, Santa strives to find a way to bring joy into the lives of all children, and eventually invents toys as a principal means. Santa later appears in *The Road to Oz* as an honored guest at Ozma's birthday party, stated to be famous and beloved enough for everyone to bow even before he is announced as "The most Mighty and Loyal Friend of Children, His Supreme Highness – Santa Claus".

Images of Santa Claus were conveyed through Haddon Sundblom's depiction of him for The Coca-Cola Company's Christmas advertising in the 1930s.^{[7][39]} The image spawned urban legends that Santa Claus was invented by The Coca-Cola Company or that Santa wears red and white because they are the colours used to promote the Coca-Cola brand.^[40] Coca-Cola's competitor Pepsi-Cola used similar Santa Claus paintings in its advertisements in the 1940s and 1950s. Historically, Coca-Cola was not the first soft drink company to utilise the modern image of Santa Claus in its advertising—White Rock Beverages had used a Santa figure in monochrome advertisements for mineral water in 1915, and in 1923–25, the same company used colour images of Santa Claus in adverts for drink mixers.^[41] Earlier, Santa Claus had appeared dressed in red and white and essentially in his current form on several covers of *Puck* magazine in the first few years of the 20th century.^[42]



A man dressed as Santa Claus fundraising for Volunteers of America on the sidewalk of street in Chicago, Illinois, in 1902. He is wearing a mask with a beard attached.



Rose O'Neill's illustration for the 1903 issue of *Puck*

The image of Santa Claus as a benevolent character became reinforced with its association with charity and philanthropy, particularly by organisations such as the Salvation Army. Volunteers dressed as Santa Claus typically became part of fundraising drives to aid needy families at Christmas time.

In 1937 Charles W. Howard, who played Santa Claus in department stores and parades, established the Charles W. Howard Santa School, the oldest continuously run such school in the world.^[43]

In some images from the early 20th century, Santa was depicted as personally making his toys by hand in a small workshop like a craftsman. Eventually, the idea emerged that he had numerous elves responsible for making the toys, but the toys were still handmade by each individual elf working in the traditional manner.

The 1956 popular song by George Melachrino, "Mrs. Santa Claus", and the 1963 children's book *How Mrs. Santa Claus Saved Christmas*, by Phyllis McGinley, helped to standardise and establish the character and role of Mrs Claus in the US.^[44]

Seabury Quinn's 1948 novel *Roads* draws from historical legends to tell the story of Santa and the origins of Christmas. Other modern additions to the "story" of Santa include Rudolph the Red-Nosed Reindeer, the 9th and lead reindeer created in 1939 by Robert L. May, a Montgomery Ward copywriter, and immortalised in a 1949 song by Gene Autry.

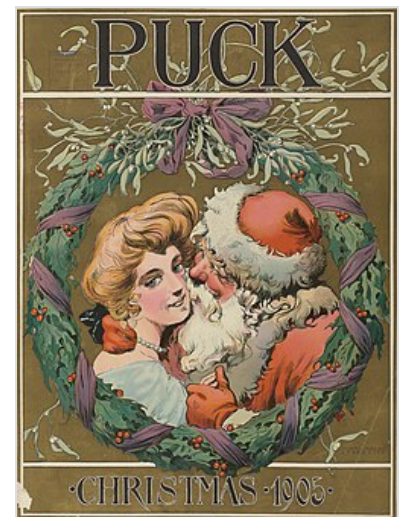
In popular culture

Elves had been portrayed as using assembly lines to produce toys early in the 20th century. That shift was reflected in the modern depiction of Santa's residence—now often humorously portrayed as a fully mechanised production and distribution facility, equipped with the latest manufacturing technology, and overseen by the elves with Santa and Mrs Claus as executives or managers.^[45]

In 1912 the actor Leedham Bantock became the first actor to be identified as having played Santa Claus in a film, *Santa Claus*, which he also directed. The film includes scenes photographed in a limited, two-tone colour process and featured the use of detailed models.^[46] Since then many feature films have featured Santa Claus as a protagonist, including *Miracle on 34th Street*, *The Santa Clause*, and *Elf*.

In the cartoon base, Santa has been voiced by several people, including Mickey Rooney, Jim Cummings, Mel Smith, Ricky Tomlinson, Jim Belushi, and Alec Baldwin.

Santa has been described as a positive male cultural icon:



Santa on the December 1905 cover of *Puck* magazine, v. 58, no. 150

Santa is really the only cultural icon we have who's male, does not carry a gun, and is all about peace, joy, giving, and caring for other people. That's part of the magic for me, especially in a culture where we've become so commercialized and hooked into manufactured icons. Santa is much more organic, integral, connected to the past, and therefore connected to the future.

—TV producer Jonathan Meath who portrays Santa, 2011^[47]

Norman Corwin's 1938 comic radio play *The Plot to Overthrow Christmas*, set entirely in rhyme, details a conspiracy of the Devil Mephistopheles and damned figures of history to defeat the good will among men of Christmas, by sending the Roman emperor Nero to the North Pole to assassinate Santa Claus. Through a battle of wits, Santa saves himself by winning Nero over to the joys of Christmas, and gives him a Stradivarius violin. The play was re-produced in 1940 and 1944.

Many television commercials, comic strips and other media depict this as a sort of humorous business, with Santa's elves acting as a sometimes mischievously disgruntled workforce, cracking jokes and pulling pranks on their boss. For instance, a Bloom County story from 15 December 1981 through 24 December 1981 has Santa rejecting the demands of PETCO (Professional Elves Toy-Making and Craft Organization) for higher wages, a hot tub in the locker room, and "Aggressive recruitment of a wider gender spectrum of employee" ("short broads"), with the elves then going on strike. Ronald Reagan steps in, fires all of Santa's helpers, and replaces them with out-of-work air traffic controllers (an obvious reference to the 1981 air traffic controllers' strike), resulting in a riot before Santa vindictively rehires them in humiliating new positions such as his reindeer.^[48] In the 2001 *The Sopranos* episode, "To Save Us All from Satan's Power", Paulie Gualtieri says he "Used to think Santa and Mrs. Claus were running a sweatshop over there. The original elves were ugly, traveled with Santa to throw bad kids a beatin', and gave the good ones toys."

In Kyrgyzstan, a mountain peak was named after Santa Claus, after a Swedish company had suggested the location be a more efficient starting place for present-delivering journeys all over the world, than Lapland. In the Kyrgyz capital, Bishkek, a Santa Claus Festival was held on 30 December 2007, with government officials attending. 2008 was officially declared the Year of Santa Claus in the country. The events are seen as moves to boost tourism in Kyrgyzstan.^[49]

The Guinness World Record for the largest gathering of Santa Clauses is held by Thrissur, Kerala, India, where on 27 December 2014, 18,112 Santas overtook the previous record. Derry City, Northern Ireland had held the record since 9 September 2007, when a total of 12,965 people dressed up as



Santa portrayed by Jonathan Meath



Santa Claus with reindeer at Hersheypark, Hershey, Pennsylvania 2021

2009 Liverpool Santa Dash

Santa or Santa's helpers. A gathering of Santas in 2009 in Bucharest, Romania attempted to top the world record, but failed with only 3,939 Santas.^[50]

Santa Claus has been featured in many video games.^[51]

In Brazil, a version of Santa with green clothes instead of red became popular through television commercials for the soft drink brand Dolly appearing along with their mascot Dollynho since the 2000s, as a form of patriotism adapting the character to the colors of the Brazilian flag and at the same time rivalling Coca-Cola commercials.^[52] Another

attempt to adapt Santa Claus to the colors of the Brazilian flag occurred in 2024 in Balneário Camboriú, Santa Catarina where a sculpture wearing yellow clothes with green gloves and bag was installed, generating controversy, being accused of making an association with the political extreme right, due to the colours being seen in protests by supporters of Jair Bolsonaro.^[53]

Traditions and rituals

Chimneys

The tradition of Santa Claus being said to enter dwellings through the chimney is shared by many European seasonal gift-givers.^[54]

Christmas Eve

In Hungary, Saint Nicolaus (Mikulás) or Father Winter (Télapó) comes on the night of 5 December and the children get their gifts the next morning. They get sweets in a bag if they were good, and a golden-coloured birch switch if not. On Christmas Eve "Little Jesus" comes and gives gifts for everyone.^[55]

In Slovenia, Saint Nicholas (Miklavž) also brings small gifts for good children on the eve of 6 December. Božiček (Christmas Man) brings gifts on the eve of 25 December, and Dedek Mraz (Grandfather Frost) brings gifts in the evening of 31 December to be opened on New Years Day.

After the children have fallen asleep, parents play the role of Santa Claus and leave their gifts under the Christmas tree, which may be signed as being "from Santa Claus".^{[56][57][58]}

Appearance

Santa is generally depicted as a portly, jolly, white-bearded man, often with glasses, wearing a red outfit consisting of jacket, trousers and hat all trimmed with white fur, accessorised with black leather belt and boots, and carrying a bag full of gifts for children. The 1823 poem "A Visit from St. Nicholas"



The Feast of Saint Nicholas by Jan Steen (c. 1665–1668)

popularised this image in North America during the 19th century. The caricaturist and political cartoonist Thomas Nast also played a role in the creation of Santa's image.^{[59][60][61]} Connections have been drawn between the camauro -- a soft red hat with white fur trim formerly worn by the pope -- and the red-and-white vesture of Santa Claus.^{[62][63][64]}

The traditional 1823 Christmas poem "A Visit from St. Nicholas" relates that Santa has "a little round belly / That shook when he laugh'd, like a bowl full of jelly".

Though most often portrayed as white, Santa is also depicted as black or of other races. His race or colour is sometimes a subject of controversy.^{[65][66]}

Laugh

Ho ho ho is the way that many languages write out how Santa Claus laughs. "**Ho, ho, ho!** Merry Christmas!" It is the textual rendition of a particular type of deep-throated laugh or chuckle, most associated today with Santa Claus and Father Christmas.

The laughter of Santa Claus has long been an important attribute by which the character is identified, but it also does not appear in many non-English-speaking countries.

Home

Santa Claus's home is traditionally said to include a residence and a workshop where he is said to create—often with the aid of elves or other supernatural beings—the gifts he is said to deliver to good children at Christmas. Some stories and legends include a village, inhabited by his helpers, surrounding his home and shop.

Santa is traditionally said to live at the North Pole, which according to Canada Post lies within Canadian jurisdiction in the postal code HoH oHo^[67] (a reference to Santa's laugh, "Ho ho ho", although postal codes starting with H are usually reserved for the island of Montréal in Québec). On 23 December 2008, Jason Kenney, the Minister of Citizenship, Immigration and Multiculturalism, formally awarded Canadian citizenship status to Santa Claus. "The Government of Canada wishes Santa the very best in his Christmas Eve duties and wants to let him know that, as a Canadian citizen, he has the automatic right to re-enter Canada once his trip around the world is complete," Kenney said in an official statement.^[68] There is also a city named North Pole in Alaska where a tourist attraction known as the "Santa Claus House" has been



An archetypal North American depiction of Santa Claus



Benedict XVI wearing a camauro, which has been likened to Santa's hat.



A man dressed as Santa Claus waves to children from an annual holiday train in Chicago, 2012.

established. The United States Postal Service recommends mail to Santa's workshop are sent to 123 Elf Road, North Pole, 88888.^[69] Royal Mail recommends letters are sent to Santa/Father Christmas, Santa's Grotto, Reindeerland, XM4 5HQ.^[70]

Each Nordic country claims Santa's residence to be within their territory. Norway claims he lives in Drøbak. In Denmark, he is said to live in Greenland (near Uummannaq). In Sweden, the town of Mora has a theme park named Tomteland. The national postal terminal in Tomtebodå in Stockholm receives children's letters for Santa. In Finland, Korvatunturi in Lapland has long been known as Santa's home, and two theme parks, Santa Claus Village and Santa Park are located near Rovaniemi.^[71] In Belarus, there is a home of Ded Moroz in Belovezhskaya Pushcha National Park.^[72]

In France, Santa is believed to reside in 1 Chemin des Nuages, Pôle Nord (1 Alley of Clouds, North Pole). The French national postal service has operated a service that allows children to send letters to Père Noël since 1962.^[73] In the period before Christmas, any physical letter in the country that is addressed to Santa Claus is sent to a specific location, where responses for the children's letters are written and sent back to the children.^[74]

Parades, department stores, and shopping malls

Actors portraying Santa Claus are present at various venues in the weeks leading up to Christmas. A concept devised by the retail entrepreneur David Lewis, the first Christmas grotto opened in Lewis's department store in Liverpool, England, in 1879.^[75] The idea then took hold throughout Britain,^[76] before extending to Australian and American department stores in the 1890s, with James Edgar starting in 1890 in his Brockton, Massachusetts, department store.^[77] Having a Santa actor set up to take pictures with children is a ritual that dates back at least to 1918.^[78] An area is often set aside for the actors portraying Santa to use for the duration of the holiday season. It usually features a chair for the actors to sit in surrounded by various holiday-themed decorations. In Canada, malls operated by Oxford Properties established a process by which autistic children could "visit Santa Claus" at the mall without having to contend with crowds.^[79] The malls open early to allow entry only to families with autistic children, who have a private visit with the actor portraying Santa Claus. In 2012 the Southcentre Mall in Calgary was the first mall to offer this service.^[80] In the UK, the discount store Poundland changes the voice of its self-service checkouts to that of Santa Claus throughout the Christmas retail period.^[81]

There are schools offering instruction on how to act as Santa Claus. For example, the children's television producer Jonathan Meath studied at the International School of Santa Claus and earned the degree *Master of Santa Claus* in 2006. It blossomed into a second career for him, and after appearing



The Santa Claus Village in Lapland (Finland), the legendary "North Pole" home of Santa



Santa's House at Jerusalem Old City, St. Peter Street

in parades and malls,^[82] he appeared on the cover of the American monthly *Boston Magazine* as Santa.^[83] There are associations with members who portray Santa; for example, Mr. Meath was a board member of the international organisation called *Fraternal Order of Real Bearded Santas*.^[84]

Due to the COVID-19 pandemic, many Santa grottos were not operating for the 2020 Christmas season. Due to this, some companies offered video calls for a fee using apps such as Zoom where children could speak to an actor who was dressed as Santa Claus.^[85]

In 2021 Walt Disney World and Disneyland featured for the first time black cast members portraying Santa.^[86]

Letter writing

Children sometimes write letters to Santa Claus, often with a wish list of presents that they wish to receive.^{[87][88]} Some postal services recognise this tradition, and may accept letters addressed to "Santa Claus".^[89] Writing letters to Santa Claus has the educational benefits of promoting literacy, computer literacy, and email literacy. A letter to Santa is often a child's first experience of correspondence. Written and sent with the help of a parent or teacher, children learn about the structure of a letter, salutations, and the use of an address and postcode.^[90]

According to the Universal Postal Union (UPU)'s 2007 study and survey of national postal operations, the United States Postal Service (USPS) has the oldest Santa letter answering effort by a national postal system. The USPS Santa letter answering effort started in 1912 out of the historic James Farley Post Office^[91] in New York, and since 1940 has been called "Operation Santa" to ensure that letters to Santa are adopted by charitable organisations, major corporations, local businesses and individuals in order to fulfill the wishes of children.^[89] Those seeking a North Pole holiday postmark through the USPS are told to send their letter from Santa or a holiday greeting card by 10 December to: North Pole Holiday Postmark, Postmaster, 4141 Postmark Dr, Anchorage, Alaska 99530–9998.^[92]

In 2006, according to the UPU's 2007 study and survey of national postal operations, La Poste received the most letters for Santa Claus or "Père Noël" with 1,220,000 letters received from 126 countries.^[93] In 2007 it specially recruited someone to answer the enormous volume of mail that was coming from Russia for Santa Claus.^[89]

Other Santa letter processing information, according to the UPU's 2007 study and survey of national postal operations, include:^[89]

- Countries whose national postal operators answer letters to Santa and other end-of-year holiday figures, and the number of letters received in 2006: Germany (500,000), Australia (117,000), Austria (6,000), Bulgaria (500), Canada (1,060,000), Spain (232,000), United States (no figure, as statistics are not kept centrally), Finland (750,000), France (1,220,000), Ireland (100,000), New



Eaton's Santa Claus Parade, 1918, Toronto, Canada. Having arrived at the Eaton's department store, Santa is readying his ladder to climb up onto the building.



Representation of Santa Claus in Italy

Zealand (110,000), Portugal (255,000), Poland (3,000), Slovakia (85,000), Sweden (150,000), Switzerland (17,863), Ukraine (5,019), United Kingdom (750,000).

- In 2006, Finland's national postal operation received letters from 150 countries (representing 90% of the letters received), France's Postal Service from 126 countries, Germany from 80 countries, and Slovakia from 20 countries.
- In 2007, Canada Post replied to letters in 26 languages and Deutsche Post in 16 languages.
- Some national postal operators make it possible to send in email messages which are answered by physical mail. All the same, Santa still receives far more letters than email through the national postal operators, proving that children still write letters. National postal operators offering the ability to use an online web form (with or without a return email address) to Santa and obtain a reply include Canada Post^[94] (online web request form in English and French), France's Postal Service (online web request form in French),^{[95][96]} and New Zealand Post^[97] (online web request form in English).^[98] In France, by 6 December 2010, a team of 60 postal elves had sent out reply cards in response to 80,000 e-mail on-line request forms and more than 500,000 physical letters.^[90]

From 2002 to 2014, Canada Post replied to approximately "one million letters or more a year, and in total answered more than 24.7 million letters";^[99] as of 2015, it responds to more than 1.5 million letters per year, "in over 30 languages, including Braille answering them all in the language they are written".^[100] The tradition also exists in Great Britain^[101] and Finland.^[90]

In Latin America, letters are sometimes tied to balloons instead of being sent through the mail.^[102]

An example of a public and private cooperative venture is the opportunity for expatriate and local children and parents to receive postmarked mail and greeting cards from Santa during December in the Finnish Embassy in Beijing,^[103] Santa Claus Village in Rovaniemi, Finland, and the People's Republic of China Postal System's Beijing International Post Office.^{[104][105][106]}

Tracking

A number of websites have been created by various organisations that have claimed to track Santa Claus's yearly journey. Some, such as NORAD Tracks Santa, the Google Santa Tracker, the emailSanta.com Tracker^[107] and the Santa Update Project, have endured. Others, such as the Airservices Australia Tracks Santa Project,^{[108][109][110]} the Dallas/Fort Worth International Airport's Tracks Santa Project,^{[111][112][113]} the NASA Tracks Santa Project,^[114] and the Bing Maps Platform Tracks Santa Project,^{[115][116]} have not.

NORAD Tracks Santa originated in 1955 when a Sears-Roebuck ad incorrectly printed the number for their Santa hotline and the Continental Air Defense Command received the calls intended for the Sears hotline. The program was transferred to NORAD when it was jointly founded by the United States and Canada in 1958.^{[117][118]}

In December 2000, the Weather Channel built upon these local efforts to provide a national Christmas Eve "Santa tracking" effort, called "SantaWatch", in cooperation with NASA, the International Space Station, and Silicon Valley-based new multimedia firm Dreamtime Holdings.^[119] Currently, most local television stations in the United States and Canada rely upon outside established "Santa tracking" efforts, such as NORAD Tracks Santa.^[120]

In addition to providing holiday-themed entertainment, "Santa tracking" websites raise interest in space technology and exploration,^[121] serve to educate children in geography^[122] and encourage them to take an interest in science.^[123]

Many websites exist that claim to track Santa and his workshop. One particular website called emailSanta.com was created when a 1997 Canada Post strike prevented Alan Kerr's young niece and nephews from sending their letters to Santa; in a few weeks, over 1,000 emails to Santa were received, and the site had received 1,000 emails a day one year later.^{[124][125]} Some websites, such as Santa's page on Microsoft's former Windows Live Spaces or emailSanta.com, have used or still use "bots" or other automated programs to compose and send personalised and realistic replies.^{[126][127]} Microsoft's website has given occasional profane results.^{[128][129]}

Criticism

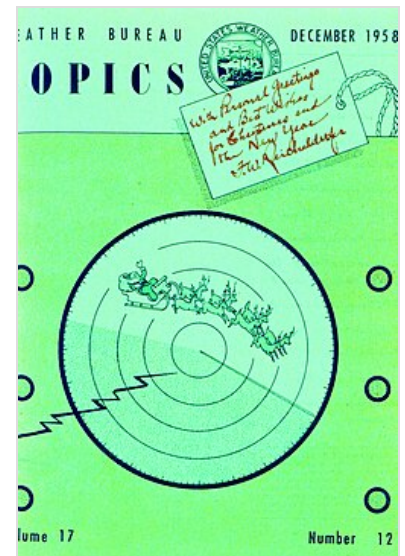
Opposition from some Christian denominations

Santa Claus has partial Christian roots in Saint Nicholas, particularly in the high church denominations that practise the veneration of him and other saints. Various Christian denominations have differing opinions of Santa Claus, ranging from acceptance to denouncement.^{[130][131]} Some Christians, particularly Calvinists such as the Puritans, disliked the idea of Santa Claus as well as Christmas in general, believing that the lavish celebrations were not in accordance with their faith.^[132] Other nonconformist Christians condemn the materialist focus of contemporary gift-giving and see Santa Claus as the symbol of that culture.^[133]

Condemnation of Christmas was prevalent among 17th-century English Puritans and Dutch Calvinists. The American colonies established by these groups reflected this view. Tolerance for Christmas increased after the Restoration, although Puritan attitudes toward the holiday remained unfavorable.^[134] In the Dutch New Netherland colony, season celebrations focused on New Year's Day.

Following the Restoration of the monarchy and with Puritans out of power in England,^[135] the ban on Christmas was satirised in works such as Josiah King's *The Examination and Tryal of Old Father Christmas; Together with his Clearing by the Jury* (1686).^[136]

In 1958 Reverend Paul Nedergaard, a clergyman in Copenhagen, declared Santa a "heathen goblin" (Danish: *en hedensk trolde*) after Santa's image was used on the annual Christmas stamp (*Julemærke*) for a Danish children's welfare organisation.^[137]



The Christmas issue of NOAA's *Weather Bureau Topics* with "Santa Claus" streaking across a weather radar screen, 1958



1955 Sears ad with the misprinted telephone number that led to the creation of the NORAD Tracks Santa program

Mary Baker Eddy, the founder of the Christian Science movement, wrote: "the children should not be taught that Santa Claus has aught to do with this Christmas pastime. A deceit or falsehood is never wise. Too much cannot be done towards guarding and guiding well the germinating and inclining thought of childhood. To mould aright the first impressions of innocence, aids in perpetuating purity and in unfolding the immortal model, man in His image and likeness."^[138]

Opposition under state atheism

Under the Marxist–Leninist doctrine of state atheism in the Soviet Union after its foundation in 1917, Christmas celebrations—along with other religious holidays—were prohibited as a result of the Soviet antireligious campaign.^{[139][140]} The League of Militant Atheists encouraged schoolchildren to campaign against Christmas traditions, among them being Santa Claus and the Christmas tree, as well as other Christian holidays including Easter; the League established an antireligious holiday to be the 31st of each month as a replacement.^{[141][142]}

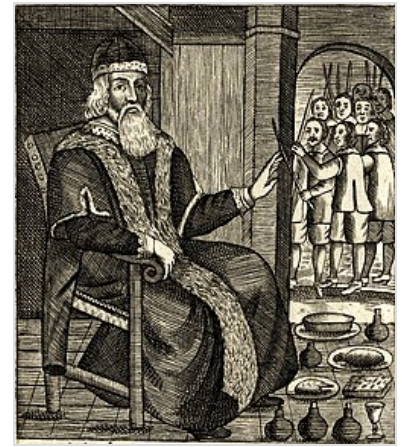
In December 2018, the city management office of Langfang in Hebei province, China, released a statement stating that people caught selling Christmas trees, wreaths, stockings or Santa Claus figures in the city would be punished by authorities.^[143]

Symbol of commercialism

Jeremy Seal, author of the 2005 book *Nicholas: The Epic Journey from Saint to Santa Claus*, said in an interview that Santa's 19th-century elements, like reindeer, a sleigh, and bells, were reminiscent of the real world.^[144]

Writing in *Mothering* magazine, Carol Jean-Swanson makes similar points, noting that the original figure of Saint Nicholas gave only to those who were needy and that today Santa Claus seems to be more about conspicuous consumption: "He [...] mirrors some of our highest ideals: childhood purity and innocence, selfless giving, unfaltering love, justice, and mercy. [...] The problem is that, in the process, he has become burdened with some of society's greatest challenges: materialism, corporate greed, and domination by the media."^[145]

In the Czech Republic, a group of advertising professionals started a website against Santa Claus, a relatively recent phenomenon in that country.^[146] In the Czech tradition, presents are delivered by Ježíšek, which translates as Baby Jesus.^[146]



Excerpt from Josiah King's *The Examination and Tryal of Father Christmas* (1686), published shortly after Christmas was reinstated as a holy day in England



Santa Claus, Sydney, 1933

In the United Kingdom, Father Christmas was historically depicted wearing a green cloak. As Father Christmas has been increasingly merged into the image of Santa Claus, that has been changed to the more commonly known red suit.^[147] Santa had been portrayed in a red suit in the 19th century by Thomas Nast among others.^[148]

A law in the US state of Ohio prohibits the usage of Santa Claus or his image to sell alcoholic beverages.^[149]

Representation to children

Psychologists generally differentiate between telling fictional stories that feature Santa Claus and actively deceiving a child into believing that Santa Claus is real. Imaginative play, in which children know that Santa Claus is only a character in a story, but pretend that he is real, just like they pretend that superheroes or other fictional characters are real, is valuable. Actively deceiving a child into believing in Santa Claus's real-world existence, sometimes even to the extent of fabricating false evidence to convince them despite their growing natural doubts, does not result in imaginative play and can promote credulity in the face of strong evidence against Santa Claus's existence.^{[151][152]} Children will eventually know that their parents deceived them.^[153]



Parent-initiated activities, like visiting a Santa actor at a shopping centre, promote belief in Santa Claus by young children.^[150]

Babies and toddlers do not understand the concept of a fictional character, but most children become developmentally able to "believe in" Santa Claus around age three or four.^{[154][150]} The prevalence of belief in Santa Claus is high at age five, and declines precipitously when children are seven or eight years old.^{[155][156][157][158]} Although the age at disillusionment has been fairly stable for decades – in 1978, 85% of American five year olds believed that Santa was real, but only 25% of eight year olds still did – it may be getting slightly lower over time.^[159] Age-inappropriate belief in Santa is seen in some older children and teenagers who have autism or other neurodevelopmental disorders.^[160]

The psychology professor Jacqueline Woolley helped to conduct a study that found that children seemed competent in their use of logic, evidence, and comparative reasoning even though they might conclude that Santa Claus or other fanciful creatures were real. According to Woolley, the existence of Santa Claus is affirmed to children by "friends, books, TV and movies" and by "hard evidence" of "half-eaten cookies and empty milk glasses".^[161]

Typical objections to presenting Santa Claus as a literally real person, rather than a story, include that:

- lying is normally bad.^[152]
- parents intentionally lying to their children promotes distrust;^[152]
- it promotes selfishness, greed, and materialism.^[162]
- it associates good behavior with being materially rewarded with presents from Santa Claus;^[162] and

- **tricking children into believing falsehoods interferes with the development of critical thinking.**^{[163][151]}

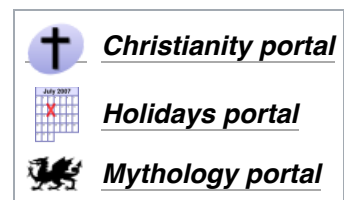
Some have argued that Santa Claus prioritises parents' short-term happiness in seeing children excited about Santa Claus, and their nostalgic willingness to prolong the age of magical thinking, over children.^[152] The philosopher David Kyle Johnson wrote, "It's a lie, it degrades your parental trustworthiness, it encourages credulity, it does not encourage imagination, and it's equivalent to bribing your kids for good behavior."^[164]

Others see little harm in the belief in Santa Claus. The psychologist Tamar Murachver said that because it is a cultural, not parental, lie, it does not usually undermine parental trust.^[165] Woolley posited that it is perhaps "kinship with the adult world" that causes children not to be angry that they were lied to for so long. In one study, it was found that children did not trust their parents less and adults did not recall an increase in lack of trust.^[166] Austin Cline argued that, to get children's belief in Santa Claus, a complicated series of elaborate lies and defenses over time is needed, rather than a few single-time lies.^[163] Most children do not remain angry or embarrassed about the deception for very long.^{[166][167]} They are most likely to have a positive feeling about it if they are able to figure it out logically (e.g., by realising the impossibility of one person visiting every home in a single night) and gradually.^{[166][167]} According to the psychologist John Condry, "The most common response to finding out the truth was that they felt older and more mature. They now knew something that the younger kids did not".^[167] In other studies, a small fraction of children felt betrayed by their parents, but disappointment was a more common response.^[152] Some children have reacted strongly, including rejecting the family's religious beliefs on the grounds that if the parents lied about the existence of Santa Claus, then they might lie about the existence of God as well.^[152] The New Zealand Skeptics also see no harm in parents telling their children that Santa is real. The spokesperson Vicki Hyde said, "It would be a hard-hearted parent indeed who frowned upon the innocent joys of our children's cultural heritage. We save our bah humbugs for the things that exploit the vulnerable."^[165]

See also

Related figures

- Amu Nowruz — "Uncle New Year"; Iranian gift-bringing figure associated with spring and the new year in the traditional Iranian calendar
- Ayaz Ata — Grandfather Frost in Turkic folklore
- Befana — a friendly witch who delivers gifts to children on 5 January
- Christkind — a popular giftbringer in Central Europe for Christmas
- Companions of Saint Nicholas
- Ded Moroz — Russian equivalent
- Father Christmas — British equivalent
- Joulupukki — Finnish Santa Claus
- Moș Gerilă — name of a character from Romanian communist propaganda
- Nikolaus — Gift bringer popular in Central Europe and the Benelux
- Olentzero — traditional Basque character who has recently been transformed into a Santa-like figure



- Saint Basil — who is believed to bring Christmas gifts for children in Greek Orthodox tradition
- Sinterklaas — Dutch Nikolaus
- The Three Kings — The Biblical three wise men brings gifts on 6 January in Spain

Other

- Jack Frost and Old Man Winter — Mythical characters associated with winter
- Christmas controversy
- Flying Santa — A northeastern US tradition of pilots delivering presents to families in remote lighthouses
- Fraternal Order of Real Bearded Santas
- Pancho Claus, a Tex-Mex version of Santa Claus
- Santa Claus, Indiana — A small Midwestern United States town named after the figure, home to Holiday World amusement park
- SantaCon

References

Citations

1. "Santa Claus: History, Legend, & Facts" (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Santa-Claus>). *Encyclopedia Britannica*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211225195200/https://www.britannica.com/topic/Santa-Claus>) from the original on 25 December 2021. Retrieved 10 August 2020.
2. B. K. Swartz, Jr.; The Origin of American Christmas Myth and Customs (<http://www.bsu.edu/web/01bkswartz/xmaspub.html>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110430004539/http://www.bsu.edu/web/01bkswartz/xmaspub.html>) 30 April 2011 at the Wayback Machine; Retrieved 22 December 2007
3. Jeff Westover; The Legendary Role of Reindeer in Christmas (<http://mymerrychristmas.com/2005/reindeer.shtml>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120803030248/http://mymerrychristmas.com/2005/reindeer.shtml>) 3 August 2012 at the Wayback Machine; Retrieved 22 December 2007
4. "Father Christmas, green or red?" (https://news.bbc.co.uk/local/york/hi/people_and_places/history/newsid_8394000/8394067.stm). BBC. 4 December 2009.
5. Guyoncourt, Sally (16 December 2023). "The number of reindeer used by Santa Claus and their names" (<https://inews.co.uk/light-relief/how-many-reindeer-santa-list-names-2812871>). *The i Paper*.
6. "A Visit from St. Nicholas | Christmas poem, Twas the Night Before Christmas, Authorship, & Facts | Britannica" (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/A-Visit-from-St-Nicholas>). *www.britannica.com*. 7 December 2024.
7. "Santa Claus: The real man behind the myth" (<https://www.nbcnews.com/id/wbna34525202>). *NBC News*. 22 December 2009. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20200901062407/http://www.nbcnews.com/id/34525202/>) from the original on 1 September 2020. Retrieved 27 December 2009.
8. "Saint Nicholas :: People" (<http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=45>). *Stnicholascenter.org*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101227181314/http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=45>) from the original on 27 December 2010. Retrieved 21 December 2010.

9. "Saint Nicholas ::: Places" (<http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=46>). [Stnicholascenter.org](http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=46). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20091214095841/http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=46>) from the original on 14 December 2009. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
10. Öller, Rudolf (2004). "Martin Luthers Christkind" (https://web.archive.org/web/20080215173835/http://www.scientific.at/2004/roe_0452.htm). *Welt der Naturwissenschaften*. Archived from the original (https://scientific.at/2004/roe_0452.php) on 15 February 2008. Retrieved 24 April 2023.
11. "Ein Verkaufsfahrer diente als Vorbild – angeblich – manager magazin" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20121230183655/http://www.manager-magazin.de/lifestyle/leute/0,2828,874273-2,00.html>). Archived from the original (<http://www.manager-magazin.de/lifestyle/leute/0,2828,874273-2,00.html>) on 30 December 2012.
12. William J. Federer (2002). "There Really Is a Santa Claus: The History of St. Nicholas & Christmas Holiday Traditions" p. 39. Amerisearch, Inc., 2002
13. Jacqueline Simpson, Steve Roud (2000) "English Folklore". Oxford University Press, 2000
14. A children's party given in England on 26 December 1842 featured 'venerable effigies' of Father Christmas and the Old Year; '... Father Christmas with scarlet coat and cocked hat, stuck all over with presents for the guests...' R. L. Brett, ed., *Barclay Fox's Journal*, Bell and Hyman, London, 1979
15. Davis, Derek H. (18 November 2010). *The Oxford Handbook of Church and State in the United States* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=yvkyAwAAQBAJ&pg=PT334>). Oxford University Press. pp. 334–. ISBN 978-0-19-020878-3. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230901170254/https://books.google.com/books?id=yvkyAwAAQBAJ&pg=PT334>) from the original on 1 September 2023. Retrieved 20 December 2017.
16. "Nibud Pers, persberichten" (https://web.archive.org/web/20091214092530/http://www.nibud.nl/over-het-nibud/pers/informatie-voor-de-pers.html?page=content&subject=persberichten&main=pe_persberichten&pag=pe_persberichten&id=100&year=2003) (in Dutch). NIBUD. 2003. Archived from the original (http://www.nibud.nl/over-het-nibud/pers/informatie-voor-de-pers.html?page=content&subject=persberichten&main=pe_persberichten&pag=pe_persberichten&id=100&year=2003) on 14 December 2009. Netherlands budget institute table showing money spent by households categorised into those that give gifts only on Sint (36%), only on Christmas day (21%), on both days (26%)
17. "Sinterklaas Arrival—Amsterdam, the Netherlands" (<http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=105>). St. Nicholas Center. 2008. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110117181712/http://www.stnicholascenter.org/Brix?pageID=105>) from the original on 17 January 2011. Retrieved 9 September 2014.
18. swissinfo.ch, Morven McLean (5 December 2008). "Schmutzli: the Swiss Santa's sinister sidekick" (<https://www.swissinfo.ch/eng/schmutzli--the-swiss-santa-s-sinister-sidekick/7082046>). *SWI swissinfo.ch*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210520205230/https://www.swissinfo.ch/eng/schmutzli--the-swiss-santa-s-sinister-sidekick/7082046>) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 25 December 2017.
19. Orchard, Andy (1997). *Dictionary of Norse Mythology and Legend*, page 187. Cassell.
20. Simek, Rudolf (2007) translated by Angela Hall. *Dictionary of Northern Mythology*, pages 379–380. D.S. Brewer. & Orchard (1997:1987).
21. For the wild hunt, Simek (2010:372–373). For *Jólnir*, see Simek (2010:180) and Orchard (1997:189). For *Langbarðr*, see Simek (2010:186).
22. For example, see McKnight, George Harley (1917). *St. Nicholas; his legend and his rôle in the Christmas celebration and other popular customs* (<http://archive.org/details/stnicholashis00mckn>). New York and London, G.P. Putman's sons. pages 24–26, 138–139 ; Fruehling Springwood, Charles (2009). "If Santa Wuz Black: The Domestication of a White Myth". In Denzin, Norman (ed.). *Studies in Symbolic Interaction*. Emerald Group Publishing. pp. 243–244. ISBN 978-1-84855-784-0.

23. Baker, Margaret (2007 1962). *Discovering Christmas Customs and Folklore: A Guide to Seasonal Rites Throughout the World*, page 62. Osprey Publishing.
24. Sirén, Ilkka. "Does Santa Claus come from Finland?" (<https://www.bbc.com/travel/story/20171221-does-santa-claus-come-from-finland>). *www.bbc.com*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210419071218/http://www.bbc.com/travel/story/20171221-does-santa-claus-come-from-finland>) from the original on 19 April 2021. Retrieved 11 December 2018.
25. "Last Monday, the anniversary of St. Nicholas, otherwise called Santa Claus, was celebrated at Protestant Hall, at Mr. Waldron's; where a great number of sons of the ancient saint the Sons of Saint Nicholas celebrated the day with great joy and festivity." *Rivington's Gazette* (New York City), 23 December 1773.
26. Fox, Justin (13 December 2019). "Christmas Was Invented in New York: The strange but probably true tale of how Washington Irving and a few contemporaries created the modern holiday in the early 1800s" (<https://www.bloomberg.com/opinion/articles/2019-12-13/how-washington-irving-influenced-the-modern-christmas-santa>). *Bloomberg*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210520204746/https://www.bloomberg.com/opinion/articles/2019-12-13/how-washington-irving-influenced-the-modern-christmas-santa>) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 24 December 2019.
27. "mentioning Don Foster, *Author Unknown: On the Trail of Anonymous* (New York: Henry Holt, 2000: 221–75) for the attribution of *Old Santeclaus* to Clement Clarke Moore" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110718194304/https://tspace.library.utoronto.ca/html/1807/4350/poem1485.html>). *Tspace.library.utoronto.ca*. Archived from the original (<https://tspace.library.utoronto.ca/html/1807/4350/poem1485.html>) on 18 July 2011. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
28. Kirkpatrick, David D. (26 October 2000). "Whose Jolly Old Elf Is That, Anyway?; Literary Sleuth Casts Doubt on the Authorship of an Iconic Christmas Poem" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2000/10/26/books/whose-jolly-old-elf-that-anyway-literary-sleuth-casts-doubt-authorship-iconic.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210520204757/https://www.nytimes.com/2000/10/26/books/whose-jolly-old-elf-that-anyway-literary-sleuth-casts-doubt-authorship-iconic.html>) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 8 January 2017.
29. "What Are the True Names of Santa's Reindeer?" (<https://www.snopes.com/fact-check/the-donner-partys-over/>). *snopes.com*. 6 June 2001. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230424094430/https://www.snopes.com/fact-check/the-donner-partys-over/>) from the original on 24 April 2023. Retrieved 24 April 2023.
30. "Advertisement for Harrison's Bookstore". *Baltimore American Republican And Daily Clipper*. No. 3. 1 January 1846.
31. The article is signed "Uneda", an anagrammatic pen-name used by William Duane (1808–1882) of Philadelphia, son of William John Duane.
32. "Notes and Queries", volume 8 (217), 24 December 1853, p.615
33. Aktuell, S. W. R. (3 December 2023). "Wie ein Pfälzer Auswanderer den Weihnachtsmann erfand" (<https://www.swr.de/swraktuell/rheinland-pfalz/ludwigshafen/pfaelzer-thomas-nast-erfand-weihnachtsmann-in-usa-100.html>). *swr.online* (in German).
34. Thomas Nast, *Santa Claus and His Works* (http://www.forensicgenealogy.info/images/nast_santa_and_his_works.jpg) Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20101215084032/http://forensicgenealogy.info/images/nast_santa_and_his_works.jpg) 15 December 2010 at the Wayback Machine, 1866. The phrase "Santa Claussville, N.P." is on the curved border to the right of center, above the large word "Claus".
35. Jeremy Seal, *Nicholas: The Epic Journey From Saint to Santa Claus*, Bloomsbury, 2005, p. 199–200. ISBN 978-1-58234-419-5.
36. Armstrong, Ralph (1875). Seaverns, Fanny P. (ed.). "A letter from Colorado" (<https://books.google.com/books?id=tIUDAAAAYAAJ>). *The Nursery*. Vol. 18. John L. Shorey. p. 43.

37. Dunlap, David W. (25 December 2015). "1933 - P.S., Virginia, There's a New York Times, Too" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2015/12/24/insider/1933-ps-virginia-theres-a-new-york-times-too.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211224152836/https://www.nytimes.com/2015/12/24/insider/1933-ps-virginia-theres-a-new-york-times-too.html>) from the original on 24 December 2021. Retrieved 25 August 2022.
38. Bever, Lindsey (22 December 2018). "'Is there a Santa Claus?': How a child's letter inspired the classic 'Yes, Virginia' response" (<https://www.washingtonpost.com/history/2018/12/22/is-there-santa-claus-how-childs-letter-inspired-classic-yes-virginia-response/>). *The Washington Post*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20220317031928/https://www.washingtonpost.com/history/2018/12/22/is-there-santa-claus-how-childs-letter-inspired-classic-yes-virginia-response/>) from the original on 17 March 2022. Retrieved 25 August 2022.
39. "Image Gallery Santa 1931" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20121115001438/http://www.coca-colacompany.com/topics/heritage#TCCC?assetId=41565&assetTag=heritage>). *Press Center*. Coca-Cola Company. Archived from the original (<http://www.coca-colacompany.com/topics/heritage#TCCC?assetId=41565&assetTag=heritage>) on 15 November 2012. Retrieved 28 October 2011.
40. Mikkelsen, David (18 December 2008). "Did Coca-Cola Invent the Modern Image of Santa Claus?" (<https://www.snopes.com/fact-check/the-claus-that-refreshes/>). *Snopes.com*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211225094514/https://www.snopes.com/fact-check/the-claus-that-refreshes/>) from the original on 25 December 2021. Retrieved 1 January 2023.
41. McKay, George. "Consumption, Coca-colonisation, Cultural resistance—and Santa Claus". In Whiteley, Sheila (ed.). *Christmas, Ideology and Popular Culture*. Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press. pp. 57–59.
42. [thumb|Santa Claus on the 1902 cover of Puck magazine](#), [thumb|Santa Claus on the 1904 cover of Puck magazine](#), [thumb|Santa Claus on the 1905 cover of Puck magazine](#).
43. Susman, Tina (30 October 2011). "Claus and effect: The ultimate Santa school" (<https://www.latimes.com/world/la-xpm-2011-oct-30-la-na-santa-school-20111031-story.html>). *Los Angeles Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171224110349/http://articles.latimes.com/2011/oct/30/nation/la-na-santa-school-20111031>) from the original on 24 December 2017. Retrieved 20 February 2020.
44. How did Santa Claus become popular in American culture? (<https://www.kiwireport.com/santa-claus-become-popular-american-culture/>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211204205320/http://www.kiwireport.com/santa-claus-become-popular-american-culture/>) 4 December 2021 at the Wayback Machine, Kiwi Report, by Jaime Levis, 2 January 2019
45. Nissenbaum, chap. 2; Belk, 87–100
46. "Santa Claus (1912)" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230408001111/https://www2.bfi.org.uk/films-tv-people/4ce2b76640dfb>). *BFI.org.uk*. British Film Institute. Archived from the original (<https://www2.bfi.org.uk/films-tv-people/4ce2b76640dfb>) on 8 April 2023. Retrieved 24 April 2023.
47. Aldrich, Ian (November 2011). "The Big Question: Why Should We Believe in Santa? We ask Kris Kringle, a.k.a. Jonathan Meath: Why Should We Believe in Santa?" (<http://www.yankeemagazine.com/issues/2011-11/features/kris-kringle>). *Yankee Magazine*. Archived (<https://archive.today/20130209205254/http://www.yankeemagazine.com/issues/2011-11/features/kris-kringle>) from the original on 9 February 2013. Retrieved 12 December 2012. "Santa is really the only cultural icon we have who's male, does not carry a gun, and is all about peace"
48. "High Five! Top Five! – Bizarre Santa Claus Cameos in Comics by Robert Bazz, December 13, 2010" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101221060142/http://highfivecomics.net/2010/12/13/high-five-top-five-bizarre-santa-claus-cameos-in-comics/>). High Five! Comics. Archived from the original (<http://highfivecomics.net/2010/12/13/high-five-top-five-bizarre-santa-claus-cameos-in-comics/>) on 21 December 2010. Retrieved 25 February 2011.

49. Pannier, Bruce (30 December 2007). "Kyrgyzstan: Central Asian Country Welcomes Santa Claus To His New Home" (<https://www.rferl.org/a/1079309.html>). *Radio Free Europe/Radio Liberty*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230607023918/https://www.rferl.org/a/1079309.html>) from the original on 7 June 2023. Retrieved 24 April 2023.
50. "Guiness [*sic*] World Record Santa Claus Costumes I WebPhotoBlog I imagini, fotografii, pictures, poze, images" (<http://www.webphoto.ro/imagini/christmas/guinness-world-record-santa-claus-costumes.html>). Webphoto.ro. 30 November 2009. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101014220210/http://www.webphoto.ro/imagini/christmas/guinness-world-record-santa-claus-costumes.html>) from the original on 14 October 2010. Retrieved 29 September 2010.
51. "10 times Santa appeared in video games" (<https://screenwanderer.com/santa-in-video-games/>). Screenwanderer.com. 25 December 2019. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211221130836/https://screenwanderer.com/santa-in-video-games/>) from the original on 21 December 2021. Retrieved 21 December 2021.
52. "As 8 campanhas de Natal mais nostálgicas de todas!" (<https://adnews.com.br/as-8-campanhas-de-natal-mais-nostalgicas-de-todas/>). ADNEWS. 25 December 2021. Retrieved 24 December 2024.
53. "Papai Noel verde e dourado em Balneário Camboriú causa discussão" (<https://g1.globo.com/sc/santa-catarina/noticia/2024/12/11/papai-noel-verde-dourado-balneario-camboriu.ghtml>). G1. 11 December 2024. Retrieved 24 December 2024.
54. Walsh, Joseph J.. *Were They Wise Men Or Kings?: The Book of Christmas Questions*. Westminster John Knox Press, 2001. ISBN 0-664-22312-5.
55. Kürti, László (2020). " "DO YOU WANT TO BE KRAMPUS?" Santa Claus, globality and locality of Christmas tradition" (<https://doi.org/10.2478%2Fhsy-2020-0010>). *Hungarian Studies Yearbook*. **2** (1). Sciendo: 128, 134. doi:10.2478/hsy-2020-0010 (<https://doi.org/10.2478%2Fhsy-2020-0010>). ISSN 2668-7542 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/2668-7542>). S2CID 231955746 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:231955746>).
56. "A Parents' Guide To Christmas: Try Not To Cry" (https://www.huffpost.com/entry/a-parents-guide-to-christmas-try-not-to-cry_b_4469967). *HuffPost*. 20 December 2013. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20211005095824/https://www.huffpost.com/entry/a-parents-guide-to-christmas-try-not-to-cry_b_4469967) from the original on 5 October 2021. Retrieved 15 July 2020.
57. Lehr, Sarah. "Meet the parents who don't keep Santa's secret" (<https://www.lansingstatejournal.com/story/news/2019/12/22/these-lansing-area-parents-celebrate-christmas-without-santas-secret/2686614001/>). *Lansing State Journal*. Archived (<https://archive.today/20211228005454/https://www.lansingstatejournal.com/story/news/2019/12/22/these-lansing-area-parents-celebrate-christmas-without-santas-secret/2686614001/>) from the original on 28 December 2021. Retrieved 15 July 2020.
58. Shabazz, Sa'iyda (17 April 2020). "The Heavy Price of Holiday Magic" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2020/04/17/parenting/holiday-money-stress.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211222062620/https://www.nytimes.com/2020/04/17/parenting/holiday-money-stress.html>) from the original on 22 December 2021. Retrieved 15 July 2020.
59. "Santa's arrival lights up the Green" (<https://archive.today/20121205232536/http://www.dailyrecord.com/article/20091128/COMMUNITIES/91127064/1005/news01/Santa-s-arrival-lights-up-the-Green>). Archived from the original (<http://www.dailyrecord.com/article/20091128/COMMUNITIES/91127064/1005/news01/Santa-s-arrival-lights-up-the-Green>) on 5 December 2012. Retrieved 2 December 2009.
60. Restad, Penne L. (5 December 1996). *Christmas in America: A History* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=0pnJDKfYi3QC&q=thomas+nast+santa+claus&pg=PA146>). Oxford University Press. ISBN 978-0-19-535509-3. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230901170344/https://books.google.com/books?id=0pnJDKfYi3QC&q=thomas+nast+santa+claus&pg=PA146>) from the original on 1 September 2023. Retrieved 2 November 2020.

61. Auchmutey, Jim (10 December 2007). "Coke denies claims it bottled familiar Santa image" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071212071411/http://www.rockymountainnews.com/news/2007/dec/10/coke-denies-claims-it-bottled-familiar-santa/>). *The Rocky Mountain News*. Archived from the original (<http://www.rockymountainnews.com/news/2007/dec/10/coke-denies-claims-it-bottled-familiar-santa/>) on 12 December 2007. Retrieved 1 January 2023.
62. "Beautiful Liturgy is hard work, Monsignor Guido Marini reminds - Communio" (<https://communio.stblogs.org/2010/12/beautiful-liturgy-is-hard-work.html>). *communio.stblogs.org*. Retrieved 4 May 2025.
63. "Pope's Santa-like hat is old school" (<https://www.newspapers.com/article/chicago-tribune-popes-santa-like-hat-is/171511738/>). *Chicago Tribune*. 23 December 2005.
64. "'Santa Pope' woos Vatican crowds" (<https://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/europe/4551348.stm>). 22 December 2005. Retrieved 5 May 2025.
65. Contreras, Russell. "Santa's Ethnicity Varies in Diverse U.S." (<https://www.nbcdfw.com/news/local/santas-ethnicity-varies-in-diverse-us/2069166/>) *NBC 5 Dallas-Fort Worth*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20221211043054/https://www.nbcdfw.com/news/local/santas-ethnicity-varies-in-diverse-us/2069166/>) from the original on 11 December 2022. Retrieved 11 December 2022.
66. "What color is Santa Claus in Appalachia?" (<https://apnews.com/article/christmas-archive-race-and-ethnicity-622312e190704eb4bd9d63683dbf6d01>). *AP NEWS*. 23 December 2017. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20221211043053/https://apnews.com/article/christmas-archive-race-and-ethnicity-622312e190704eb4bd9d63683dbf6d01>) from the original on 11 December 2022. Retrieved 11 December 2022.
67. "Canada Post – Newsroom – Letters to the Editor" (https://web.archive.org/web/20080424005801/http://www.canadapost.ca/corporate/about/newsroom/letters_editor/letters-e.asp?l=belleville). 24 April 2008. Archived from the original (http://www.canadapost.ca/corporate/about/newsroom/letters_editor/letters-e.asp?l=belleville) on 24 April 2008.
68. "Santa Claus declared a Canadian citizen" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101230042547/http://www.torontosun.com/news/canada/2008/12/23/7839591.html>). *Toronto Sun*. 23 December 2008. Archived from the original (<http://www.torontosun.com/news/canada/2008/12/23/7839591.html>) on 30 December 2010. Retrieved 24 April 2023.
69. "USPS Operation Santa program. FAQ" (<https://www.uspsoperationsanta.com/faqs>). *USPS*. Retrieved 16 October 2024.
70. "Letters to Santa" (<https://www.royalmail.com/christmas/letters-to-santa>). *Royal Mail*. Retrieved 16 October 2024.
71. Gettleman, Jeffrey (15 April 2025). "Santa Lives in Rovaniemi, Finland. Some of His Neighbors Are Not Thrilled" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2025/04/15/world/asia/santa-finland-rovaniemi.html>). *The New York Times*. Retrieved 16 April 2025.
72. "Беловежская пуца – Фотознциклопедия Беларуси" (<http://www.fotobel.by/belovezhskaya-pushha/>) (in Russian). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210513065644/http://www.fotobel.by/belovezhskaya-pushha/>) from the original on 13 May 2021. Retrieved 12 December 2015.
73. "Quelle est la véritable adresse du Père Noël ?" (<https://www.momes.net/calendrier-fetes/noel/la-veritable-adresse-du-pere-noel-848218>). *MOMES.net* (in French). 25 July 2014. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211226014917/https://www.momes.net/calendrier-fetes/noel/la-veritable-adresse-du-pere-noel-848218>) from the original on 26 December 2021. Retrieved 26 December 2021.
74. Choffat, Axelle. "Lettre au Père Noël 2021: date, adresse... Les infos clés" (<https://www.linternaute.com/actualite/guide-vie-quotidienne/1349506-lettre-au-pere-noel-2021-date-adresse-les-infos-cles/>). *www.linternaute.com* (in French). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211226014917/https://www.linternaute.com/actualite/guide-vie-quotidienne/1349506-lettre-au-pere-noel-2021-date-adresse-les-infos-cles/>) from the original on 26 December 2021. Retrieved 26 December 2021.

75. "Liverpool's record breaking Christmas grotto beloved by generations" (<https://www.liverpoolecho.co.uk/news/nostalgia/liverpools-record-breaking-christmas-grotto-25517874>). *Liverpool Echo*. Retrieved 15 October 2024.
76. "Inside the Grotto" (<https://www.architecture.com/explore-architecture/inside-the-riba-collections/inside-the-grotto>). Royal Institute of British Architects. Retrieved 16 October 2024.
77. Allegrini, Elaine (15 November 2008). "James Edgar's Santa Claus—the spirit of Christmas" (<http://web.archive.org/web/20131227050557/http://www.enterpriseneews.com/homepage/x1013044544/James-Edgar-s-Santa-Claus-the-spirit-of-Christmas>). *The Enterprise*. Brockton, Massachusetts. Archived from the original (<http://www.enterpriseneews.com/homepage/x1013044544/James-Edgar-s-Santa-Claus-the-spirit-of-Christmas>) on 27 December 2013. Retrieved 29 November 2009.
78. "A Visit from St. Nick" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101224044032/http://squareamerica.com/sa1.htm>). Squareamerica.com. Archived from the original (<http://www.squareamerica.com/sa1.htm>) on 24 December 2010. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
79. DeMara, Bruce (25 November 2013). "Autistic kids get quiet time with Santa at malls" (https://www.thestar.com/life/2013/11/25/autistic_kids_get_quiet_time_with_santa_at_malls.html). *Toronto Star*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20131224113811/http://www.thestar.com/life/2013/11/25/autistic_kids_get_quiet_time_with_santa_at_malls.html) from the original on 24 December 2013. Retrieved 21 December 2013.
80. "Canadian malls offer quieter, calmer visits with Santa for kids with autism" (<https://www.ctvnews.ca/canada/article/canadian-malls-offer-quieter-calmer-visits-with-santa-for-kids-with-autism/>). CTVNews. 24 November 2013. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210520204754/https://www.ctvnews.ca/canada/canadian-malls-offer-quieter-calmer-visits-with-santa-for-kids-with-autism-1.1558284>) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 21 December 2013.
81. Elsom, Jack (1 November 2018). "WATCH: Elvis, Dracula and Santa entertain customers at Poundland store in Derry" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190830085143/https://www.derrynow.com/news/watch-elvis-dracula-santa-entertain-customers-poundland-store-derry/255759>). *Derry Now*. Archived from the original (<https://www.derrynow.com/news/watch-elvis-dracula-santa-entertain-customers-poundland-store-derry/255759>) on 30 August 2019. Retrieved 30 August 2019.
82. Edward B. Colby (3 December 2009). "Town in the spirit: Dedham Square to be filled with song, shopping" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110721190925/http://www.dailynewstranscript.com/entertainment/x1945276785/Town-in-the-spirit-Dedham-Square-to-be-filled-with-song-shopping>). *Dedham Transcript*. Archived from the original (<http://www.dailynewstranscript.com/entertainment/x1945276785/Town-in-the-spirit-Dedham-Square-to-be-filled-with-song-shopping>) on 21 July 2011. Retrieved 13 November 2010. "DEDHAM—The fifth annual Dedham Square Holiday Stroll this ... At 6 p.m., Jonathan Meath – better known as Santa JG, who performs with the Boston Pops – will entertain children and families at Cafe Video Paradiso with a sing-along with Santa. "We booked him months ago because we knew that he's in demand this time of year," Haelsen says."
83. Mary Ann Georgantopoulos (23 December 2007). "Miracle on Mass. Ave.: City Santa takes suit seriously" (https://www.boston.com/news/local/articles/2007/12/23/miracle_on_mass_ave_city_santa_takes_suit_seriously/). *The Boston Globe*. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20160305032754/http://www.boston.com/news/local/articles/2007/12/23/miracle_on_mass_ave_city_santa_takes_suit_seriously/) from the original on 5 March 2016. Retrieved 13 November 2010. "Santa Claus is coming to town. More accurately, he's from town—Cambridge that is. Jonathan Meath is the perfect fit for a Santa."
84. Santa Glen, secretary (October 2010). "Minutes of meeting" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101022231420/http://www.realsantasandiego.com/Minutes.htm>). San Diego Chapter of F.O.R.B.S. Archived from the original (<http://www.realsantasandiego.com/Minutes.htm>) on 22 October 2010. Retrieved 13 November 2010. "Hello fellow Santas, Once again we had an informative and fun gathering. Ten Santas were in attendance and we were happy to welcome Karilyn Curran, the chair person of our up and coming Santa Luncheon for 2011. ... Fashion Show: ... Jonathan Meath ..."

85. "Santa to visit virtually as Christmas grottos cancelled" (<https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-54816579>). *BBC News*. 5 November 2020. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210806145701/https://www.bbc.com/news/technology-54816579>) from the original on 6 August 2021. Retrieved 17 November 2020.
86. Chang, Rachel. "There Are Now Black Santas at Walt Disney World and Disneyland for the First Time in History" (<https://www.travelandleisure.com/travel-news/black-santas-appearing-at-disneyland-and-disney-world-for-first-time>). *Travel + Leisure*. Meredith. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211221233723/https://www.travelandleisure.com/travel-news/black-santas-appearing-at-disneyland-and-disney-world-for-first-time>) from the original on 21 December 2021. Retrieved 1 December 2021.
87. Halkoaho, Jenniina; Laaksonen, Pirjo (2009). "Understanding What Christmas Gifts Mean to Children" (https://web.archive.org/web/20110927152024/http://www.emeraldinsight.com/promo/xmas/understanding_what.pdf) (PDF). *Young Consumers*. **10** (3): 251. doi:10.1108/17473610910986053 (<https://doi.org/10.1108%2F17473610910986053>). Archived from the original (http://www.emeraldinsight.com/promo/xmas/understanding_what.pdf) (PDF) on 27 September 2011. Retrieved 12 December 2010.
88. Otnes, Cele; Kim, Kyungseung; Kim, Young Chan (1994). "Yes, Virginia, there is a gender difference: Analyzing children's requests to Santa Claus". *Journal of Popular Culture*. **28** (1): 23. doi:10.1111/j.0022-3840.1994.2801_17.x (https://doi.org/10.1111%2Fj.0022-3840.1994.2801_17.x).
89. "Santa Claus receives more than six million letters annually and growing, 20 Dec 2007" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110508083650/http://www.asiantribune.com/node/8798>). *Asian Tribune*. Archived from the original (<http://www.asiantribune.com/node/8798>) on 8 May 2011. Retrieved 12 December 2010.
90. "No small job for postal elves, 15 Dec 2010" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101222172930/http://www.upu.int/en/media-centre/news/union-postale-emag/underway-news/article/1/no-small-job-for-postal-elves.html>). Universal Postal Union – UPU. Archived from the original (<http://www.upu.int/en/media-centre/news/union-postale-emag/underway-news/article/1/no-small-job-for-postal-elves.html>) on 22 December 2010. Retrieved 17 December 2010.
91. "Operation Santa Claus at James Farley Post Office 2012 | Operation Santa Claus – Santa's Blog" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20111128235359/http://operationsanta.com/operation-santa-claus-at-james-farley-post-office-2012/>). 15 November 2011. Archived from the original (<http://operationsanta.com/operation-santa-claus-at-james-farley-post-office-2012/>) on 28 November 2011. Retrieved 10 December 2011.
92. "Santa Mail – Letters to Santa" (http://about.usps.com/news/electronic-press-kits/holidaynews/2014/holiday_santa.htm#letterstosanta). Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20201112032503/http://about.usps.com/news/electronic-press-kits/holidaynews/2014/holiday_santa.htm#letterstosanta) from the original on 12 November 2020. Retrieved 25 November 2014.
93. "France answers the most Santa letters, 21 Dec 2007" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120317001340/http://www.xmas.co.uk/news/2007/Dec/france-answers-the-most-santa-letters.html>). *xmas.co.uk*. 21 December 2007. Archived from the original (<http://www.xmas.co.uk/news/2007/Dec/france-answers-the-most-santa-letters.html>) on 17 March 2012. Retrieved 12 December 2010.
94. "Canada Post – Holiday – Santa's Corner" (<http://www.canadapost.ca/dec/santa/writesanta/default-e.asp>). *Canadapost.ca*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101225075922/http://www.canadapost.ca/dec/santa/writesanta/default-e.asp>) from the original on 25 December 2010. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
95. "LA POSTE | Père Noël" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110720164020/http://www.laposte.fr/pere-noel/LaPoste-PereNoel.html>) (in French). *Laposte.fr*. Archived from the original (<http://www.laposte.fr/pere-noel/LaPoste-PereNoel.html>) on 20 July 2011. Retrieved 21 December 2010.

96. "Father Christmas's French office open, 18 Nov 2010" (<http://www.connexionfrance.com/Father-Christmas-Le-Pere-Noel-12267-view-article.html>). *The Connexion*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101213141850/http://connexionfrance.com/Father-Christmas-Le-Pere-Noel-12267-view-article.html>) from the original on 13 December 2010. Retrieved 12 December 2010.
97. "Send a letter to Santa | New Zealand Post" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120121194158/http://www.nzpost.co.nz/home/christmas-2010/santa-letter>). Nzpost.co.nz. Archived from the original (<http://www.nzpost.co.nz/home/christmas-2010/santa-letter>) on 21 January 2012. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
98. "NZ Post to tighten net for Santa, by Alexis Grant, 30 Nov 2004" (http://www.nzherald.co.nz/technology/news/article.cfm?c_id=5&objectid=8500944). *The New Zealand Herald*. 30 November 2004. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20110810055550/http://www.nzherald.co.nz/technology/news/article.cfm?c_id=5&objectid=8500944) from the original on 10 August 2011. Retrieved 12 December 2010.
99. "Time to write to Santa!" (https://web.archive.org/web/20160409141219/https://www.canadapost.ca/web/en/blogs/announcements/details.page?article=2015%2F11%2F19%2Ftime_to_write_to_santa&catttype=announcements&cat=newsreleases). *Canada Post*. 19 November 2015. Archived from the original (https://www.canadapost.ca/web/en/blogs/announcements/details.page?article=2015/11/19/time_to_write_to_santa&catttype=announcements&cat=newsreleases) on 9 April 2016. Retrieved 2 August 2016.
100. "Write to Santa and he'll write you back!" (https://www.canadapost.ca/web/en/blogs/consumer/details.page?article=2015/11/05/create_magic_this_ch&catttype=Consumer&cat=living). Canada Post. 5 November 2015. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20160817230456/https://www.canadapost.ca/web/en/blogs/consumer/details.page?article=2015/11/05/create_magic_this_ch&catttype=Consumer&cat=living) from the original on 17 August 2016. Retrieved 2 August 2016.
101. "Christmas letters to Santa" (<http://www.royalmail.com/letters-to-santa>). Royal Mail. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180619192129/https://www.royalmail.com/letters-to-santa>) from the original on 19 June 2018. Retrieved 27 December 2013.
102. "Letters to Santa Claus". (2000). In *The World Encyclopedia of Christmas*. Gerry Bowler, Editor. Toronto: McClelland & Stewart Limited. pp. 131–132.
103. "About this site – Embassy of Finland, Beijing – Consulates General of Finland, Shanghai and Guangzhou: Current Affairs" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20070711022508/http://www.finland.cn/public/default.aspx?contentid=89807&contentlan=2&culture=en-US>). Finland.cn. 16 May 2007. Archived from the original (<http://www.finland.cn/public/default.aspx?contentid=89807&contentlan=2&culture=en-US>) on 11 July 2007. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
104. "Beijing Post Office" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110707222247/http://www.beijingyourway.com/2010/10/beijing-post-office/>). Beijing Your Way. Archived from the original (<http://www.beijingyourway.com/2010/10/beijing-post-office/>) on 7 July 2011. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
105. "Beijing International Post Office" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20080107083118/http://vip.fesco.com.cn/bipto/en.htm>). Vip.fesco.com.cn. Archived from the original (<http://vip.fesco.com.cn/bipto/en.htm>) on 7 January 2008. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
106. "Say hello to Santa Claus, November 24, 2010 by Zhao Hongyi" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20111201062433/http://www.beijngtoday.com.cn/tag/post-office>). *Beijing Today*. Archived from the original (<http://www.beijngtoday.com.cn/tag/post-office>) on 1 December 2011. Retrieved 12 December 2010.
107. Ribeiro, Ricky. "EmailSanta.com: How Santa Claus Went Digital" (<https://biztechmagazine.com/article/2012/12/emailsantacom-how-santa-claus-went-digital>). *BizTech Magazine*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211112165334/https://biztechmagazine.com/article/2012/12/emailsantacom-how-santa-claus-went-digital>) from the original on 12 November 2021. Retrieved 19 July 2020.

108. "Santa 2010 website by Airservices Australia" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101220044335/http://mirror.airservicesaustralia.com/santa10/santa.asp>). Mirror.airservicesaustralia.com. Archived from the original (<http://mirror.airservicesaustralia.com/santa10/santa.asp>) on 20 December 2010. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
109. "Safe Travels Santa! We will Be Watching, 19 Dec 2005" (https://web.archive.org/web/20110216115503/http://www.cdsc.nasa.gov/Features/pg_santa2005.html). NASA's Canberra Deep Space Communications Complex. Archived from the original (https://www.cdsc.nasa.gov/features/pg_santa2005.html) on 16 February 2011. Retrieved 4 December 2010.
110. "New technology to map Santa's flight, 24 Dec 2009" (<http://www.gladstoneobserver.com.au/story/2009/12/24/technology-to-map-santas-flight/>). *The Observer*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110706104932/http://www.gladstoneobserver.com.au/story/2009/12/24/technology-to-map-santas-flight/>) from the original on 6 July 2011. Retrieved 5 December 2010.
111. "DFW airport unveils Santa Tracker website, 18 Dec 2006" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110826144826/http://www.pegasusnews.com/news/2006/dec/18/dfw-airport-unveils-santa-tracker-website/>). PegNews wire. Archived from the original (<http://www.pegasusnews.com/news/2006/dec/18/dfw-airport-unveils-santa-tracker-website/>) on 26 August 2011. Retrieved 4 December 2010.
112. "DFW Airport's 'Santa Tracker' Is Operational, by BJ Austin, 24 Dec 2009" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110805201451/http://www.publicbroadcasting.net/kera/news.newsmain/article/1/0/1592516/North.Texas.DFW.Airport%27s.%27Santa.Tracker%27.Is.Operational>). PBS KERA. Archived from the original (<http://www.publicbroadcasting.net/kera/news.newsmain/article/1/0/1592516/North.Texas.DFW.Airport's.'Santa.Tracker'.Is.Operational>) on 5 August 2011. Retrieved 4 December 2010.
113. "From NORAD Santa Tracker To Twitter: Santa Tracking For Christmas Eve 2009, by Danny Sullivan, 23 Dec 2009" (<http://searchengineland.com/santa-tracking-for-christmas-eve-2009-32427>). Search Engine Land. 24 December 2009. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110521060746/http://searchengineland.com/santa-tracking-for-christmas-eve-2009-32427>) from the original on 21 May 2011. Retrieved 5 December 2010.
114. "Here Comes Santa Claus! Watch it on the Web!, 24 Dec 2005" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110808170053/http://www.wral.com/business/blogpost/1103523/>). WRAL.com – Raleigh, Durham, Fayetteville – North Carolina's TV Station website. Archived from the original (<http://www.wral.com/business/blogpost/1103523/>) on 8 August 2011. Retrieved 4 December 2010.
115. "Welcome to The North Pole – A Virtual Earth 3D Experience!" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110811021732/http://today.msnbc.msn.com/id/28241481/>). MSNBC. Archived from the original (<http://today.msnbc.msn.com/id/28241481/>) on 11 August 2011. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
116. "Tracking Santa with Bing Maps, by Chris Pendleton, 24 Dec 2009" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20100100101223315/http://www.bing.com/toolbox/blogs/maps/archive/2009/12/24/tracking-santa-with-bing-maps-in-2009.aspx>). Microsoft. Archived from the original (<https://www.bing.com/toolbox/blogs/maps/archive/2009/12/24/tracking-santa-with-bing-maps-in-2009.aspx>) on 1 January 2010. Retrieved 5 December 2010.
117. Gurnon, Emily (23 December 2014). "How A Sears Typo Led To NORAD's Santa Tracker" (<https://www.forbes.com/sites/nextavenue/2014/12/23/how-a-sears-typo-led-to-norads-santa-tracker/>). *Forbes*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210520205202/https://www.forbes.com/sites/nextavenue/2014/12/23/how-a-sears-typo-led-to-norads-santa-tracker/>) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 24 December 2014.
118. "Norad Santa Tracker: Christmas tradition began with a wrong number" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20141225053546/http://www.cbc.ca/news/norad-santa-tracker-christmas-tradition-began-with-a-wrong-number-1.2883284>). *CBC News*. CBC. 24 December 2014. Archived from the original (<http://www.cbc.ca/news/norad-santa-tracker-christmas-tradition-began-with-a-wrong-number-1.2883284>) on 25 December 2014. Retrieved 24 December 2014.

119. "SantaWatch: Hunt for Santa to Include Clues from the International Space Station, by Dreamtime, 18 Dec 2000" (<http://www.spaceref.com/news/viewpr.html?pid=3376>). Dreamtime. 18 December 2000. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211227231405/http://www.spaceref.com/news/viewpr.html?pid=3376>) from the original on 27 December 2021. Retrieved 11 December 2010.
120. "Keep track of Santa thanks to NORAD, by WKTV News, 24 Dec 2009" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110927170902/http://www.wktv.com/news/local/80067537.html>). Dreamtime. Archived from the original (<http://www.wktv.com/news/local/80067537.html>) on 27 September 2011. Retrieved 11 December 2010.
121. "NORAD Tracks Santa – Citation – Space Certification Program as a Corporate Patron Level Partner in the Certified Imagination Product Category, December 2007" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20100925011818/http://www.spaceconnection.org/certified-products/norad-tracks-santa>). Space Foundation. Archived from the original on 25 September 2010. Retrieved 31 December 2009.
122. "Hi-tech helps track Santa Claus, December 24, 2008" (<https://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/technology/7792256.stm>). *BBC News*. 24 December 2008. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210916095555/http://news.bbc.co.uk/2/hi/technology/7792256.stm>) from the original on 16 September 2021. Retrieved 31 December 2009.
123. "You'd Better Not Pout! Booz Allen Supports NORAD to Track Santa's Approach This Year, December 1, 2010 by Booz Allen Hamilton" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101210172240/http://www.boozallen.com/media-center/press-releases/48399320/NORAD-tracks-santa>). Booz Allen Hamilton. Archived from the original (<http://www.boozallen.com/media-center/press-releases/48399320/NORAD-tracks-santa>) on 10 December 2010. Retrieved 1 December 2010.
124. Rueb, Emily S. (21 December 2019). "Trying to Reach the North Pole? Check Your Wi-Fi" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2019/12/21/style/who-responds-to-santas-letters.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211103015812/https://www.nytimes.com/2019/12/21/style/who-responds-to-santas-letters.html>) from the original on 3 November 2021. Retrieved 14 June 2020.
125. "Calgary Santa receives wishes and cries for help in emails from around the world" (<https://calgaryherald.com/news/local-news/calgary-santa-receives-wishes-and-cries-for-help-in-emails-from-around-the-world>). *Calgary Herald*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211104161957/https://calgaryherald.com/news/local-news/calgary-santa-receives-wishes-and-cries-for-help-in-emails-from-around-the-world>) from the original on 4 November 2021. Retrieved 14 June 2020.
126. Ribeiro, Ricky (19 December 2012). "EmailSanta.com: How Santa Claus Went Digital" (<https://biztechmagazine.com/article/2012/12/emailsantacom-how-santa-claus-went-digital>). *BizTech Magazine*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211112165334/https://biztechmagazine.com/article/2012/12/emailsantacom-how-santa-claus-went-digital>) from the original on 12 November 2021. Retrieved 19 July 2020. "It now offers kids and parents personalized messages from Santa, which run from an ASP script that Kerr built himself."
127. Vnuk, Helen (7 December 2017). "Email Santa and get a reply: the website making my kids believe" (<https://www.mamamia.com.au/email-santa-and-get-a-reply/>). *MamaMia.com.au*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211102185519/https://www.mamamia.com.au/email-santa-and-get-a-reply/>) from the original on 2 November 2021. Retrieved 19 July 2020. "The one thing that's convinced my daughter, more than anything else, that Santa is real is a website, emailSanta.com."
128. "Microsoft pulls plug on potty-mouth Santa, by John Fontana, 4 Dec 2007" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20121013161007/http://www.networkworld.com/news/2007/120407-microsoft-santa-bot.html>). Network World. Archived from the original (<http://www.networkworld.com/news/2007/120407-microsoft-santa-bot.html>) on 13 October 2012. Retrieved 9 December 2010.
129. "For a Jolly Good Time, Chat With Santa on Windows Live Messenger, 13 Dec 2006" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20071024145241/https://www.microsoft.com/presspass/press/2006/dec06/12-13SantalIMPR.mspx>). Microsoft. Archived from the original (<https://www.microsoft.com/presspass/press/2006/dec06/12-13SantalIMPR.mspx>) on 24 October 2007. Retrieved 9 December 2010.

130. Santa Claus: The great imposter (<http://www.av1611.org/othpubls/santa.html>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101119120225/http://av1611.org/othpubls/santa.html>) 19 November 2010 at the Wayback Machine, Terry Watkins, Dial-the-Truth Ministries.
131. Cochran, Sylvia. "To Santa or Not to Santa" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20080605161911/http://www.familiesonlinemagazine.com/christian-parenting/christian-santa.html>). *familiesonlinemagazine.com*. Archived from the original (<http://www.familiesonlinemagazine.com/christian-parenting/christian-santa.html>) on 5 June 2008.
132. Kippenberg, Hans G.; Kuiper, Yme B.; Sanders, Andy F. (1 January 1990). *Concepts of Person in Religion and Thought*. Walter de Gruyter. p. 363. ISBN 978-3-11-087437-2.
133. Bowler, Gerry (27 July 2011). *Santa Claus: A Biography*. Random House. ISBN 978-1-55199-608-0.
134. "When Christmas Was Banned – The early colonies and Christmas" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20100108033515/http://www.apuritansmind.com/Christmas/DankoChristmasBanned.htm>). Archived from the original (<http://www.apuritansmind.com/Christmas/DankoChristmasBanned.htm>) on 8 January 2010.
135. "History – Ten Ages of Christmas" (https://web.archive.org/web/20050313041241/http://www.bbc.co.uk/history/society_culture/society/ten_ages_gallery_03.shtml). BBC. 13 March 2005. Archived from the original (https://www.bbc.co.uk/history/society_culture/society/ten_ages_gallery_03.shtml) on 13 March 2005. Retrieved 21 December 2010.
136. Nissenbaum, chap. 1
137. Clar, Mimi (October 1959). "Attack on Santa Claus" (<https://doi.org/10.2307/1497769>). *Western Folklore*. **18** (4): 337. doi:10.2307/1497769 (<https://doi.org/10.2307/1497769>). JSTOR 1497769 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/1497769>).
138. Eddy, Mary Baker (1925). *Miscellany*, p. 261, in *Prose Works other than Science and Health*. Trustees under the will of Mary Baker G. Eddy, Boston, USA.
139. Connelly, Mark (2000). *Christmas at the Movies: Images of Christmas in American, British and European Cinema*. I.B.Tauris. p. 186. ISBN 978-1-86064-397-2. "A chapter on representations of *Christmas* in Soviet cinema could, in fact be the shortest in this collection: suffice it to say that there were, at least officially, no Christmas celebrations in the atheist socialist state after its foundation in 1917."
140. *Echo of Islam*. MIG. 1993. "In the former Soviet Union, fir trees were usually put up to mark New Year's day, following a tradition established by the officially atheist state."
141. Luzer, Daniel (26 November 2013). "What a Real War on Christmas Looks Like" (<https://psmag.com/social-justice/whats-real-war-christmas-look-like-70524>). *Pacific Standard*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20221114030311/https://psmag.com/social-justice/whats-real-war-christmas-look-like-70524>) from the original on 14 November 2022. Retrieved 12 November 2014. "There were several anti-religious campaigns, the most dramatic of which occurred in the 1920s. According to a piece published by the School of Russian and Asia Studies: In 1925, Christmas was effectively banned under the officially atheist Soviet government, and never returned to Russia until 1992. The New Year celebration usurped the traditions of a Christmas Tree (Ёлка), Santa (known in Russian as "Дед Мороз" or "Grandfather Frost"), and presents. In the Russian tradition, Grandfather Frost's granddaughter, the Snow Maiden (Снегурочка), always accompanies him to help distribute the gifts. Elves are not associated with the holiday. The state prohibited people from selling Christmas trees. There were even festivals, organized by the League of Militant Atheists, specifically to denigrate religious holidays. Their carnivals were inspired by similar events staged by activists after the French Revolution. From 1923 to 1924 and then again from 1929 to 1930 the "Komsomol Christmases" and Easters were basically holiday celebrations of atheism."

142. Ramet, Sabrina Petra (10 November 2005). *Religious Policy in the Soviet Union*. Cambridge University Press. p. 138. ISBN 978-0-521-02230-9. "The League sallied forth to save the day from this putative religious revival. *Antireligioznik* obliged with so many articles that it devoted an entire section of its annual index for 1928 to anti-religious training in the schools. More such material followed in 1929, and a flood of it the next year. It recommended what Lenin and others earlier had explicitly condemned—carnivals, farces, and games to intimidate and purge the youth of religious belief. It suggested that pupils campaign against customs associated with Christmas (including Christmas trees) and Easter. Some schools, the League approvingly reported, staged an anti-religious day on the 31st of each month. Not teachers but the League's local set the programme for this special occasion."
143. "Santa Claus won't be coming to this town, as Chinese officials ban Christmas" (<https://www.scmp.com/news/china/society/article/2178532/santa-claus-wont-be-coming-town-chinese-officials-ban-christmas>). *South China Morning Post*. 18 December 2018. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190112085857/https://www.scmp.com/news/china/society/article/2178532/santa-claus-wont-be-coming-town-chinese-officials-ban-christmas>) from the original on 12 January 2019. Retrieved 23 December 2018. "Christmas is not a recognised holiday in mainland China – where the ruling party is officially atheist – and for many years authorities have taken a tough stance on anyone who celebrates it in public. ... The statement by Langfang officials said that anyone caught selling Christmas trees, wreaths, stockings or Santa Claus figures in the city would be punished. ... While the ban on the sale of Christmas goods might appear to be directed at retailers, it also comes amid a crackdown on Christians practising their religion across the country. On Saturday morning, more than 60 police officers and officials stormed a children's Bible class in Guangzhou, capital of southern China's Guangdong province. The incident came after authorities shut down the 1,500-member Zion Church in Beijing in September and Chengdu's 500-member Early Rain Covenant Church last week. In the case of the latter, about 100 worshippers were snatched from their homes or from the streets in coordinated raids."
144. "Interview: Jeremy Seal" (<https://www.stnicholascenter.org/who-is-st-nicholas/origin-of-santa/jeremy-seal>). *St. Nicholas Center*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230101193404/https://www.stnicholascenter.org/who-is-st-nicholas/origin-of-santa/jeremy-seal>) from the original on 1 January 2023. Retrieved 1 January 2023.
145. "In defense of Santa Claus" (https://archive.today/20071226135150/http://findarticles.com/p/article/s/mi_m0838/is_n65/ai_12694470/print). Archived from the original (http://findarticles.com/p/article/s/mi_m0838/is_n65/ai_12694470/print) on 26 December 2007. Retrieved 7 September 2016., Carol-Jean Swanson, *Mothering*, Fall 1992.
146. "Better Watch Out, Better Not Cry" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20070120090521/http://www.praguepost.com/articles/2006/12/13/better-watch-out-better-not-cry.php>). Archived from the original (<http://www.praguepost.com/articles/2006/12/13/better-watch-out-better-not-cry.php>) on 20 January 2007. Retrieved 13 December 2007., Hilda Hoy, *The Prague Post*, 13 December 2006.
147. "Santa goes green!" (https://www.bbc.co.uk/northyorkshire/content/articles/2007/11/26/green_father_christmas_feature.shtml). BBC. 26 November 2007. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20210520204757/http://www.bbc.co.uk/northyorkshire/content/articles/2007/11/26/green_father_christmas_feature.shtml) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 24 April 2023.
148. "Nast, Thomas: "Merry Old Santa Claus" – Encyclopædia Britannica" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20110406045244/http://www.britannica.com/EBchecked/media/67600/Merry-Old-Santa-Claus-by-Thomas-Nast>). Britannica.com. Archived from the original (<http://www.britannica.com/EBchecked/media/67600/Merry-Old-Santa-Claus-by-Thomas-Nast>) on 6 April 2011. Retrieved 11 June 2013.
149. "Spuds Can't Promote Beer Dressed as Santa" (<https://apnews.com/46558bab3fdc7f357896effdc47163f2>). *Associated Press News*. 2 December 1987. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180929234527/https://apnews.com/46558bab3fdc7f357896effdc47163f2>) from the original on 29 September 2018. Retrieved 23 November 2012.

150. Kapitány, Rohan; Nelson, Nicole; Burdett, Emily R. R.; Goldstein, Thalia R. (17 June 2020). Jong, Jonathan (ed.). "The child's pantheon: Children's hierarchical belief structure in real and non-real figures" (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC7299553>). *PLOS ONE*. **15** (6) e0234142. Bibcode:2020PLoSO..1534142K (<https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2020PLoSO..1534142K>). doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0234142 (<https://doi.org/10.1371%2Fjournal.pone.0234142>). ISSN 1932-6203 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/1932-6203>). PMC 7299553 (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC7299553>). PMID 32555692 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/32555692>).
151. Johnson, David Kyle. "Say Goodbye to the Santa Claus Lie" (<http://www.psychologytoday.com/blog/plato-pop/201212/say-goodbye-the-santa-claus-lie>). *Psychology Today*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211227231420/https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/plato-pop/201212/say-goodbye-the-santa-claus-lie>) from the original on 27 December 2021. Retrieved 12 December 2018.
152. Lowe, Scott C., ed. (2010). *Christmas – Philosophy for Everyone: Better than a Lump of Coal* (<https://archive.org/details/christmasphiloso0000unse/page/143>). Malden, Mass.: Wiley-Blackwell. pp. 143–147 (<https://archive.org/details/christmasphiloso0000unse/page/143>). ISBN 978-1-4443-3090-8. OCLC 539086689 (<https://search.worldcat.org/oclc/539086689>).
153. Heizer, Sophie (9 December 2018). "We asked five experts: should I lie to my children about Santa?" (<https://theconversation.com/we-asked-five-experts-should-i-lie-to-my-children-about-santa-106930>). *The Conversation*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230101193431/https://theconversation.com/we-asked-five-experts-should-i-lie-to-my-children-about-santa-106930>) from the original on 1 January 2023. Retrieved 1 January 2023.
154. Howard, Jacqueline (19 December 2017). "How many kids still believe in Santa?" (<https://www.cnn.com/2017/12/19/health/kids-santa-claus-belief-parent-curve-intl/index.html>). *CNN*. Retrieved 4 September 2023.
155. Khazan, Olga (21 December 2014). "When Do Kids Stop Believing in Santa?" (<https://www.theatlantic.com/health/archive/2014/12/when-do-kids-stop-believing-in-santa/383958/>). *The Atlantic*. Retrieved 4 September 2023.
156. "Children stop believing in Santa Claus by age of eight: Survey" (<https://www.hindustantimes.com/sex-and-relationships/children-stop-believing-in-santa-claus-by-age-of-eight-survey/story-uhKxmgTgGg58xZq5EV4PdM.html>). *Hindustan Times*. 17 December 2018. Retrieved 4 September 2023.
157. "When do kids stop believing in Santa? Is your kid ready?" (<https://www.boston.com/culture/parenting/2014/12/24/is-your-child-ready-to-have-the-santa-talk>). *www.boston.com*. Retrieved 4 September 2023.
158. Daley, Jason. "When Do Children Give Up on Santa?" (<https://www.smithsonianmag.com/smart-news/kids-give-santa-age-8-adults-still-want-believe-180971063/>). *Smithsonian Magazine*. Retrieved 4 September 2023.
159. Victor, Daniel (25 December 2018). "Kids, Please Don't Read This Article on What Trump Said About Santa Claus" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2018/12/25/us/politics/trump-santa-claus-believer.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Retrieved 4 September 2023.
160. Matson, Johnny L.; Sturmey, Peter (16 June 2011). *International Handbook of Autism and Pervasive Developmental Disorders* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=-tDR9c7kOxkC&pg=PA68>). Springer Science & Business Media. p. 68. ISBN 978-1-4419-8065-6.
161. Woolley, Jacqueline (23 December 2006). "Opinion I Do You Believe in Surnits?" (<https://www.nytimes.com/2006/12/23/opinion/23woolley.html>). *The New York Times*. ISSN 0362-4331 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0362-4331>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170328224121/http://www.nytimes.com/2006/12/23/opinion/23woolley.html>) from the original on 28 March 2017. Retrieved 1 January 2023.

162. Vines, Gail (2011). "The Santa Delusion" (<https://www.newscientist.com/article/mg19626351-500-the-santa-delusion/>). *New Scientist*. **210** (2809): 29. Bibcode:2011NewSc.210Q..29M (<https://ui.adsabs.harvard.edu/abs/2011NewSc.210Q..29M>). doi:10.1016/S0262-4079(11)60920-2 (<https://doi.org/10.1016%2FS0262-4079%2811%2960920-2>). Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210520205000/https://www.newscientist.com/article/mg19626351-500-the-santa-delusion/>) from the original on 20 May 2021. Retrieved 12 December 2018.
163. Cline, Austin (30 July 2018). "Why Parents Shouldn't Let Their Children Know About Santa Claus" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20190414223550/https://www.thoughtco.com/should-parents-perpetuate-the-santa-claus-myth-249579>). *ThoughtCo*. Archived from the original (<https://www.thoughtco.com/should-parents-perpetuate-the-santa-claus-myth-249579>) on 14 April 2019. Retrieved 31 March 2025.
164. "Lying To Kids About Santa Can Erode Their Trust, Psychologists Say" (<https://web.archive.org/web/20210119122646/https://www.vocativ.com/378177/lying-to-kids-about-santa-is-a-big-mistake-psychologists-say/>). *Vocativ*. 25 November 2016. Archived from the original (<https://www.vocativ.com/378177/lying-to-kids-about-santa-is-a-big-mistake-psychologists-say/>) on 19 January 2021. Retrieved 6 December 2018.
165. "How to deal with the 'is Santa real?'" (<http://www.stuff.co.nz/dominion-post/archive/national-news/186155>). *The Dominion Post*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20101219085719/http://www.stuff.co.nz/dominion-post/archive/national-news/186155>) from the original on 19 December 2010. Retrieved 7 November 2011.
166. Mills, Candice M.; Goldstein, Thalia R.; Kanumuru, Pallavi; Monroe, Anthony J.; Quintero, Natalie B. (13 November 2023). "Debunking the Santa myth: The process and aftermath of becoming skeptical about Santa" (<https://doi.org/10.1037%2Fdev0001662>). *Developmental Psychology*. **60** (1): 1–16. doi:10.1037/dev0001662 (<https://doi.org/10.1037%2Fdev0001662>). ISSN 1939-0599 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/1939-0599>). PMID 37956037 (<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/37956037>). S2CID 265157363 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:265157363>).
167. Kutner, Lawrence (21 November 1991). "Children can learn the wrong lessons from little lies" (<http://www.nytimes.com/1991/11/21/garden/parent-child.html>). *The New York Times*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20230208090445/https://www.nytimes.com/1991/11/21/garden/parent-child.html>) from the original on 8 February 2023. Retrieved 24 April 2023.

General and cited references

- Belk, Russell. 1989. "Materialism with the modern U.S. Christmas (<http://muse.jhu.edu/login?uri=/journals/asr/v001/1.1belk.html>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20111201063439/http://muse.jhu.edu/login?uri=/journals/asr/v001/1.1belk.html>) 1 December 2011 at the Wayback Machine". In *Interpretive Consumer Research*, ed. by Elizabeth C. Hirschman, Provo, UT: Association for Consumer Research, 75–104.
- Bowler, Gerry, Editor (2004). *The World Encyclopedia of Christmas* (<http://www.mcclelland.com/catalog/display.pperl?isbn=9780771015359>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20121028083103/http://www.mcclelland.com/catalog/display.pperl?isbn=9780771015359>) 28 October 2012 at the Wayback Machine, Toronto: McClelland & Stewart Limited. ISBN 978-0-7710-1535-9 (0-7710-1535-6)
- Bowler, Gerry, (2007). *Santa Claus: A Biography* (<http://www.mcclelland.com/catalog/display.pperl?isbn=9780771016684>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20121028083107/http://www.mcclelland.com/catalog/display.pperl?isbn=9780771016684>) 28 October 2012 at the Wayback Machine, Toronto: McClelland & Stewart Limited. ISBN 978-0-7710-1668-4 (0-7710-1668-9)
- Crump, William D. Editor (2006). *The Christmas Encyclopedia*, 2nd edition (<http://www.mcfarlandpub.com/book-2.php?id=978-0-7864-2293-7>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20120309143618/http://www.mcfarlandpub.com/book-2.php?id=978-0-7864-2293-7>) 9 March 2012 at the

Wayback Machine, Jefferson, North Carolina: McFarland & Company, Inc., Publishers, ISBN 978-0-7864-2293-7

- Nissenbaum, Stephen (1997). *The Battle for Christmas* (<http://www.randomhouse.com/catalog/display.pperl?isbn=9780679740384>) Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20211006120048/http://www.randomhouse.com/catalog/display.pperl?isbn=9780679740384>) 6 October 2021 at the *Wayback Machine*, New York: Alfred A. Knopf, ISBN 978-0-679-74038-4 (0-679-74038-4)

Further reading

- Joffe-Walt, Chana (19 December 2012). "Without Magic, Santa Would Need 12 Million Employees" (<https://www.npr.org/blogs/money/2012/12/19/167570321/without-magic-santa-would-need-12-million-employees>). *All Things Considered*. NPR. Retrieved 20 December 2012.

External links

- An article on the History of Santa Claus from the St. Nicholas Center (<http://www.stnicholascenter.org/pages/who-is-st-nicholas/>)
 - The History of Santa Claus and Father Christmas (<http://www.arthuriana.co.uk/xmas/>)
 - Research guides for Thomas Nast and Santa Claus at The Morristown & Morris Township Public Library, NJ (https://web.archive.org/web/20110424032843/http://jfpl.org/NJHistoryPathfinders.cfm?doc_id=31)
 - "The Knickerbockers Rescue Santa Claus: 'Claas Schlaschenschlinger' from James Kirke Paulding's *The Book of Saint Nicholas*" (1836) (<https://archive.org/details/TheKnickerbockersRescueSantaClausJamesKirkePaulding>)
 - NORAD Tracks Santa (<https://www.noradsanta.org/>)
 - emailSanta.com Tracker (<https://www.emailsanta.com/>)
-

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Santa_Claus&oldid=1317744933"